

Course : Application and Web Application Security

Lab : Hosting a Webapp on XAMPP

Objective: To set up and host a web application on XAMPP to enable efficient local testing and debugging using components such as Apache, MySQL and PHP

Tools required: XAMPP

Prerequisites: None

Steps to be followed:

1. Download the E-Diary management system project
2. Host a webapp on XAMPP

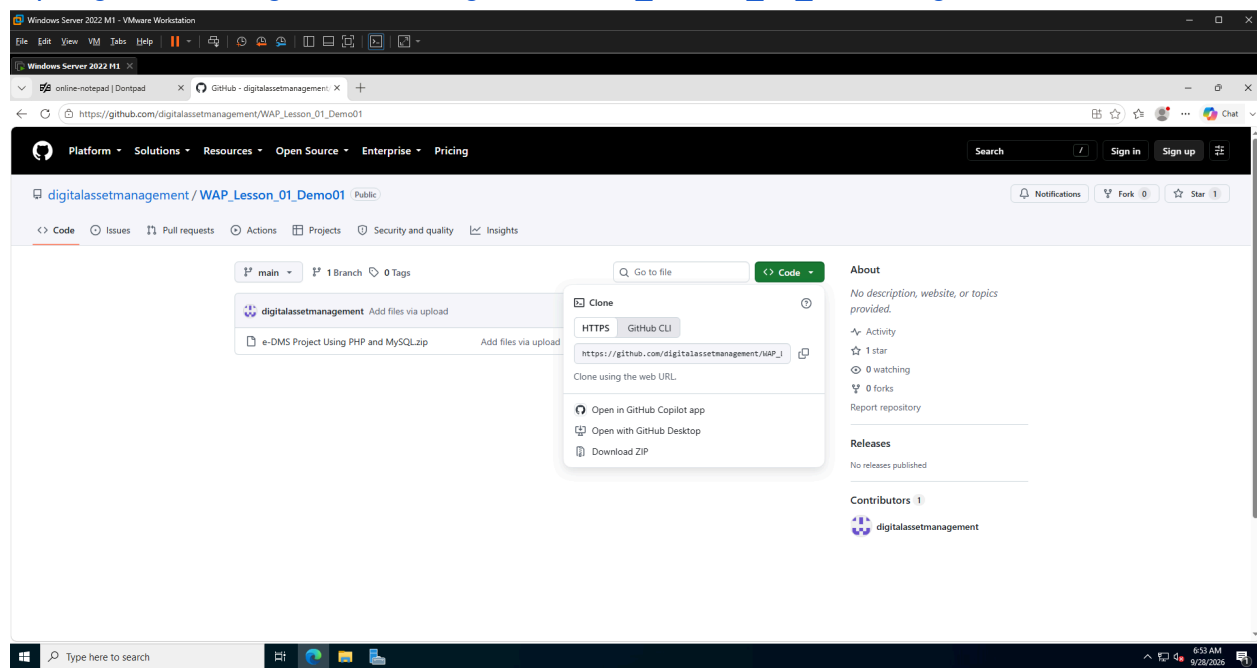
Step 1: Download the E-Diary management system project

1.1 Navigate to LabVM

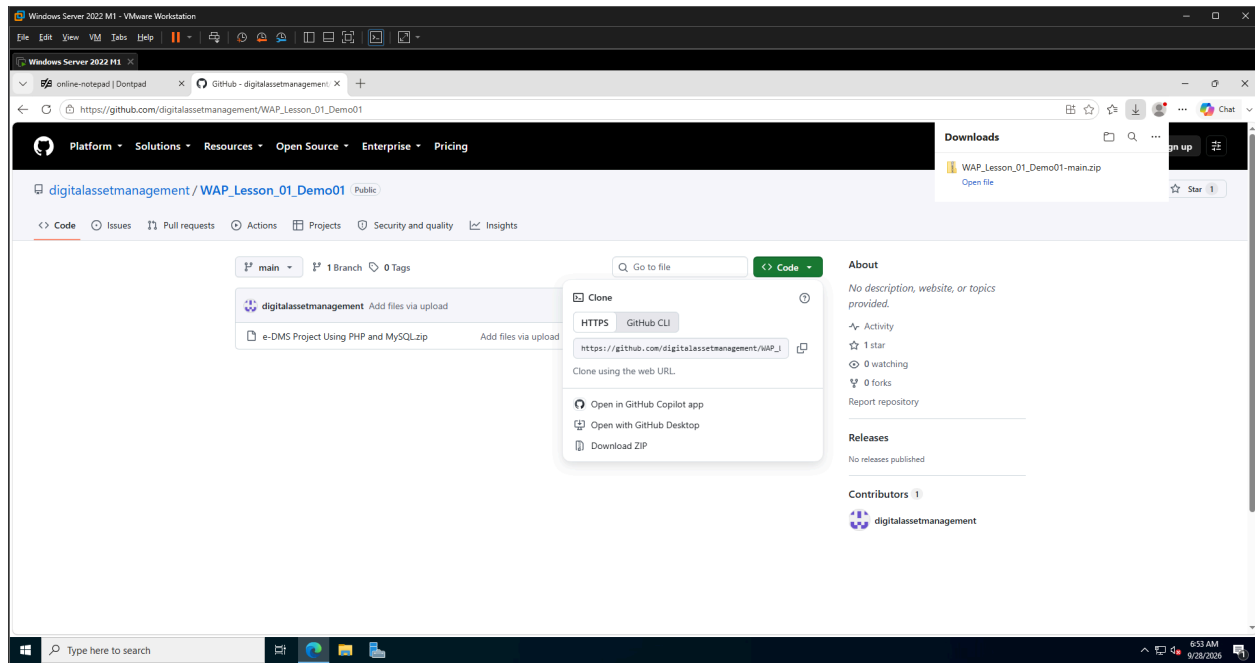
1.2 Open the Microsoft Edge browser

1.3 Open browser and navigate to the following link:

https://github.com/digitalassetmanagement/WAP_Lesson_01_Demo01.git

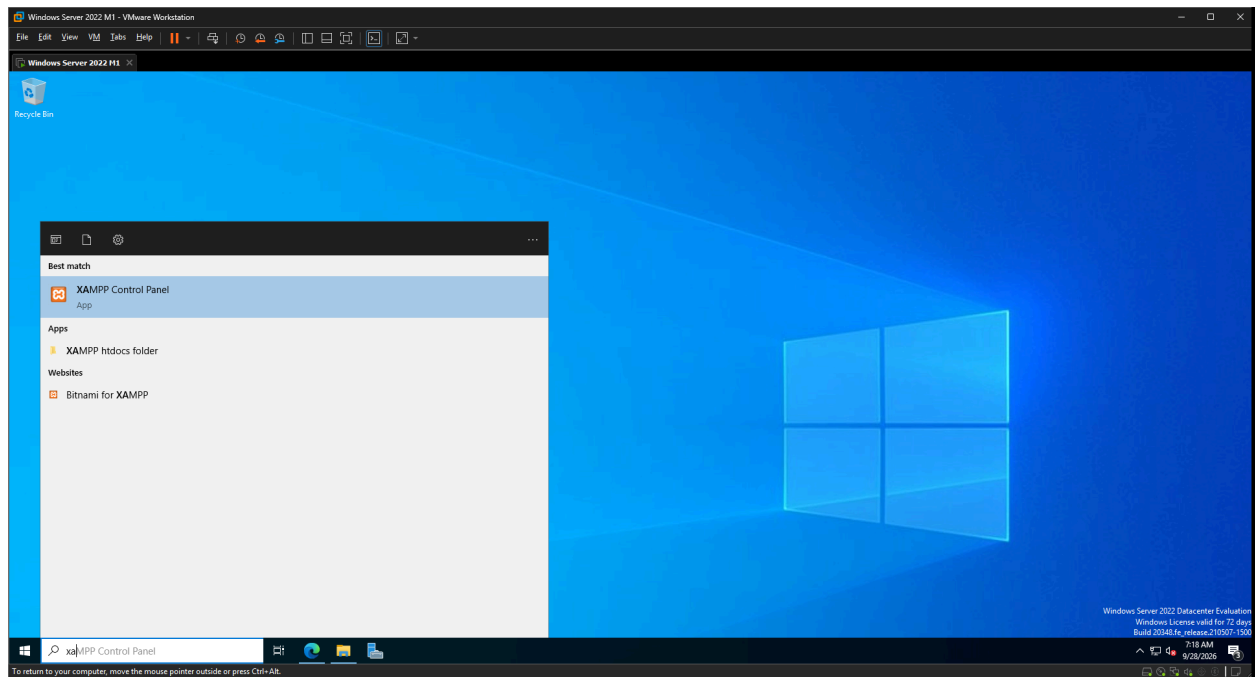


1.4 Click Code and select Download ZIP

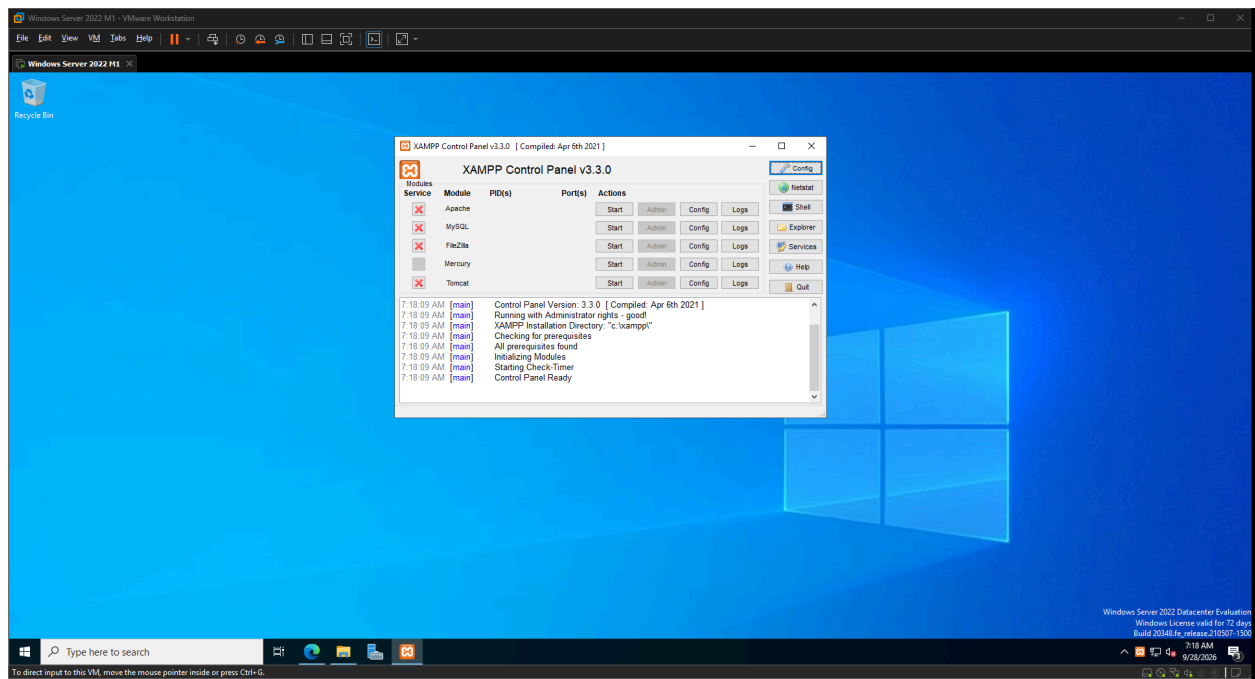


Step 2: Host a webapp on XAMPP

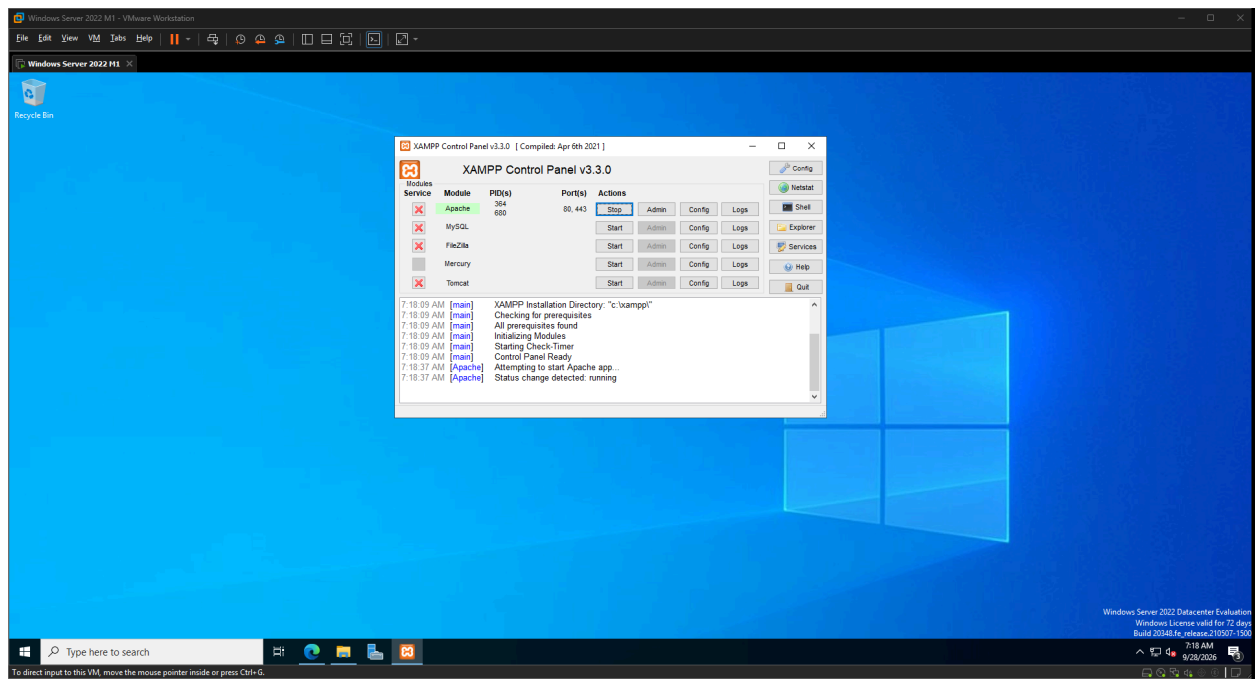
2.1 Type XAMPP Control Panel in the windows search bar and press Enter:



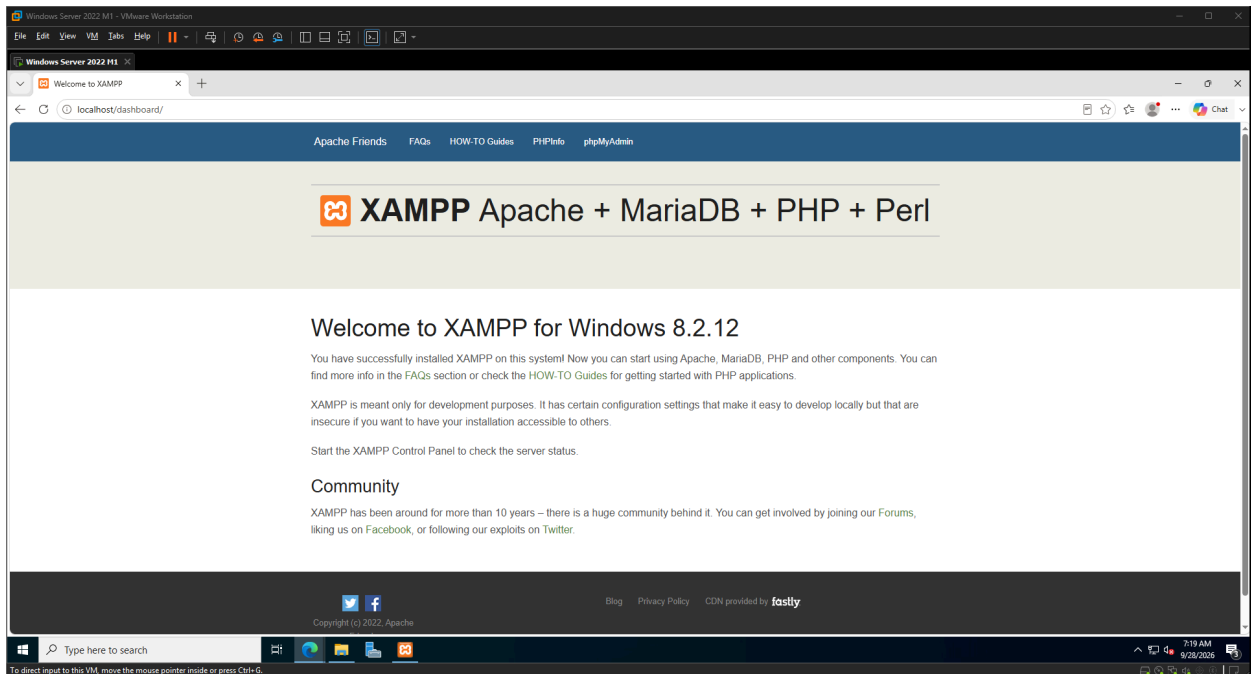
2.2 Open XAMPP and click Start under Actions to start Apache



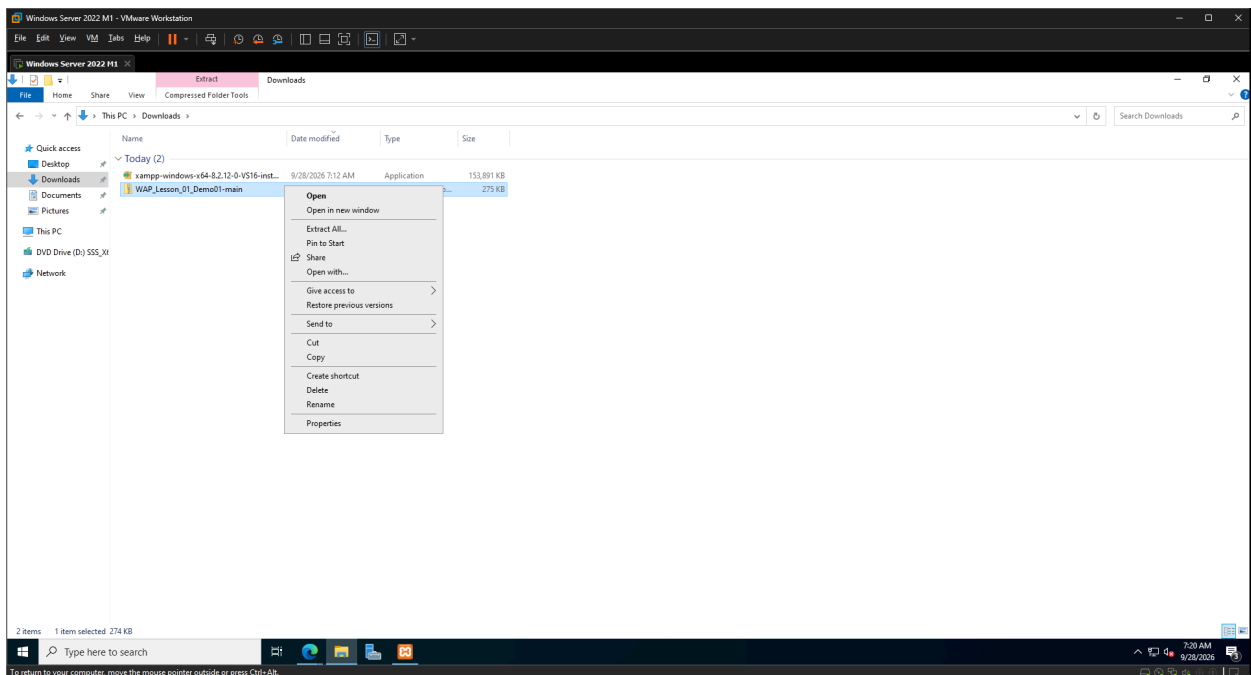
The Apache gets started, as shown in the following image:



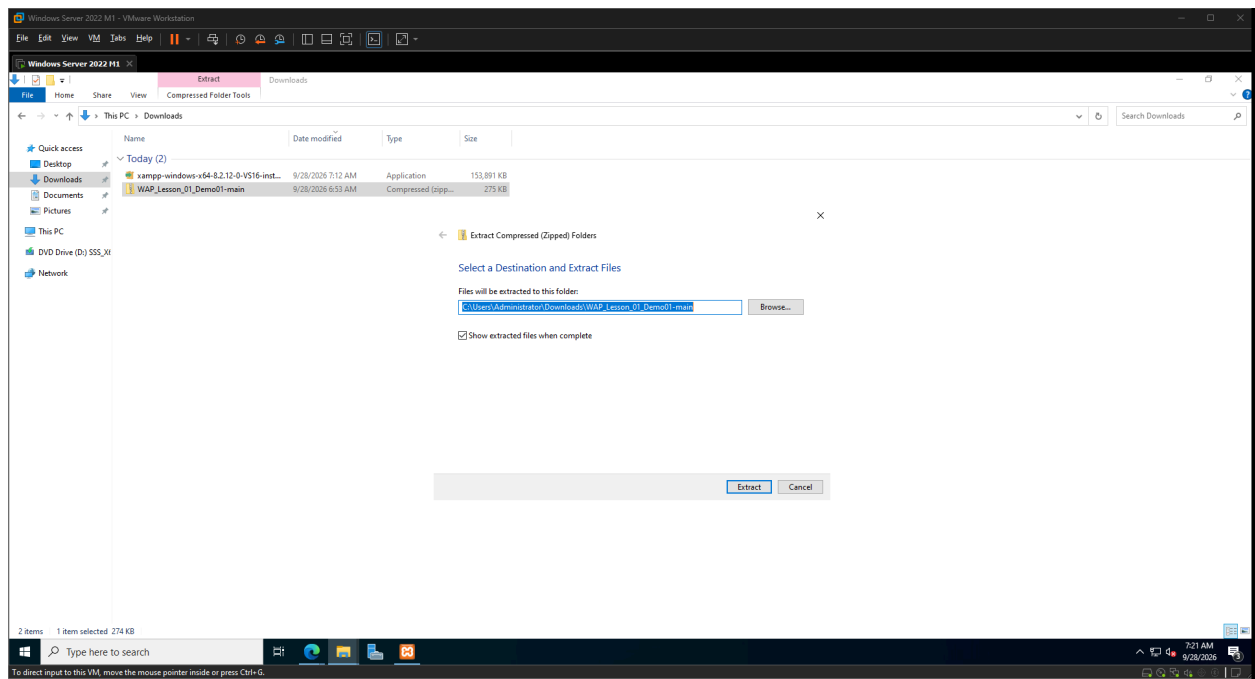
2.3 Click Microsoft Edge and enter the following URL in the address bar:
localhost/dashboard/



2.4 Navigate to the *Downloads* folder, right-click *WAP_Lesson_01_Demo01-main* and click *Extract All...*

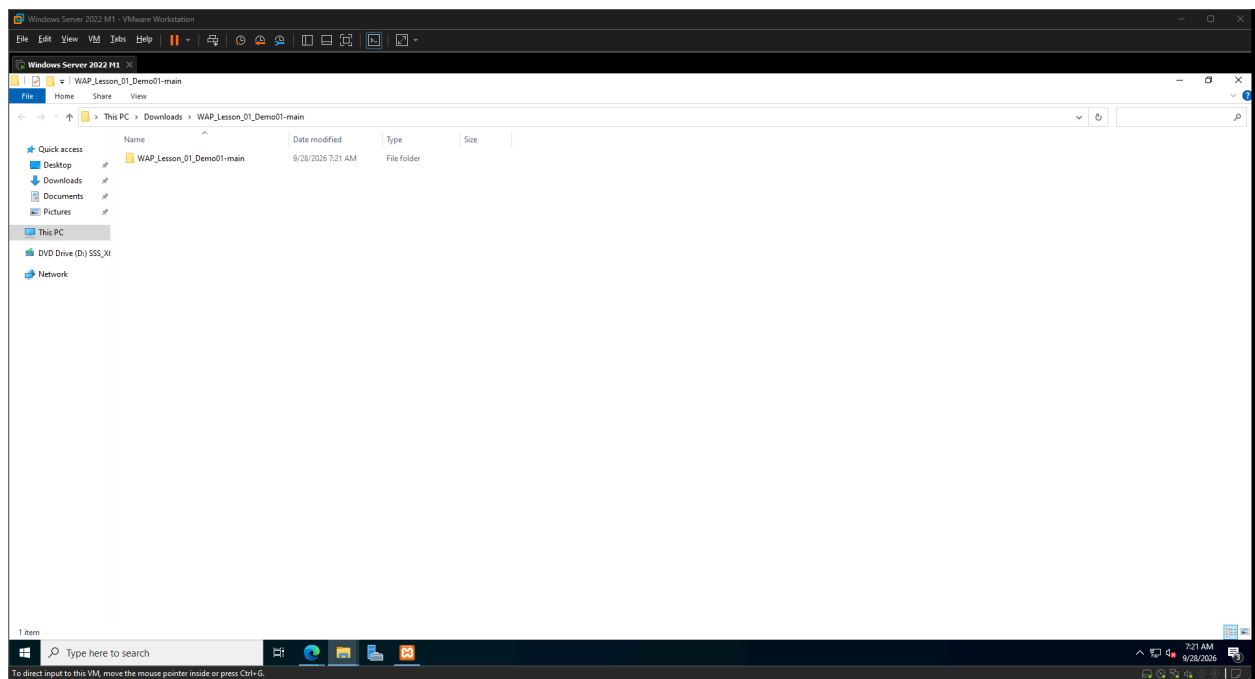


2.5 Click *Extract*

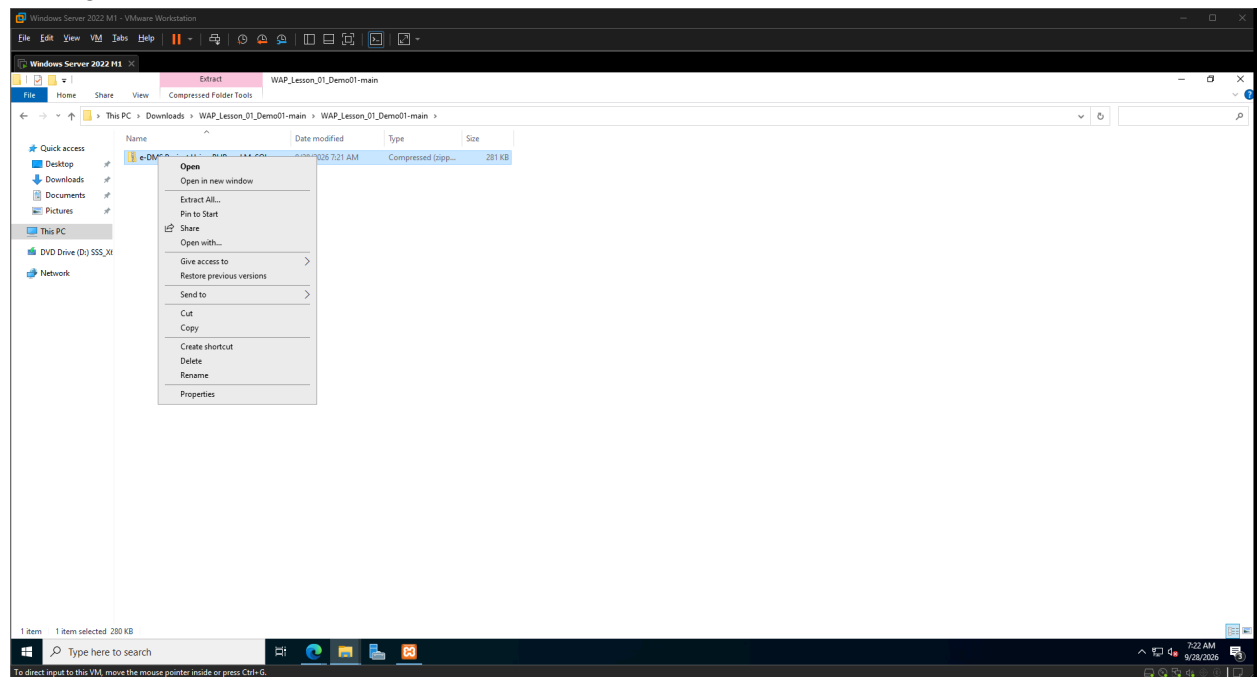


The following page appears:

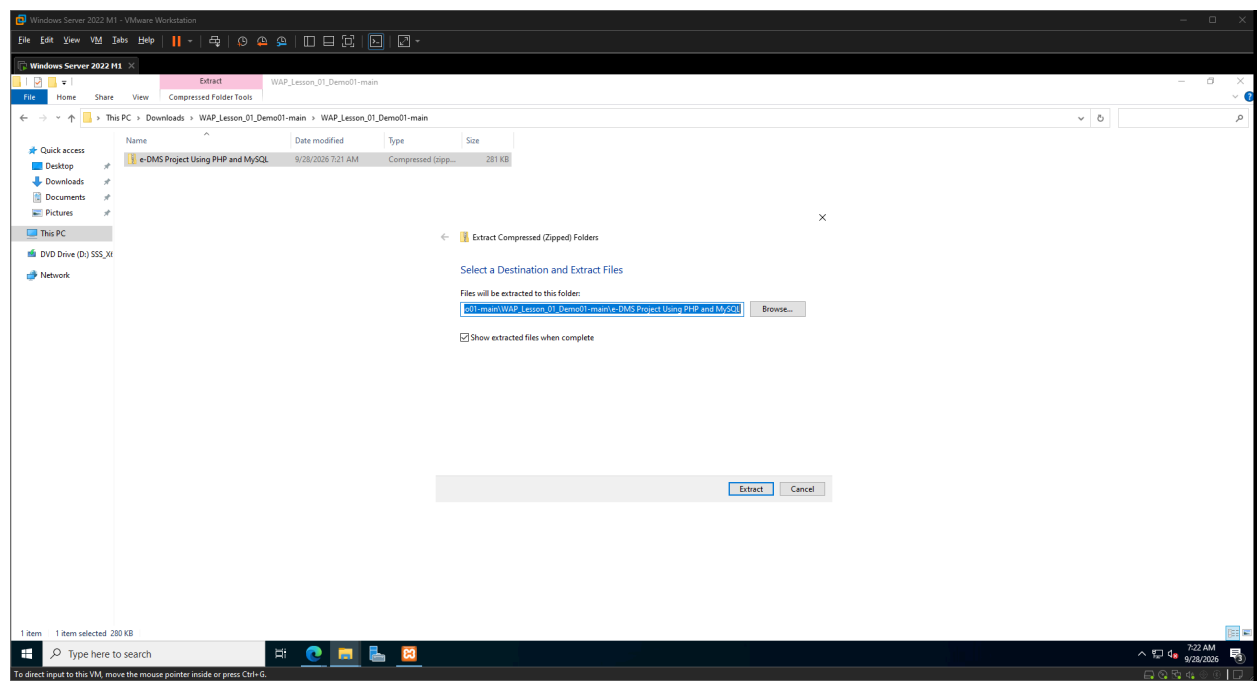
2.6 Double-click *WAP_Lesson_01_Demo01-main*



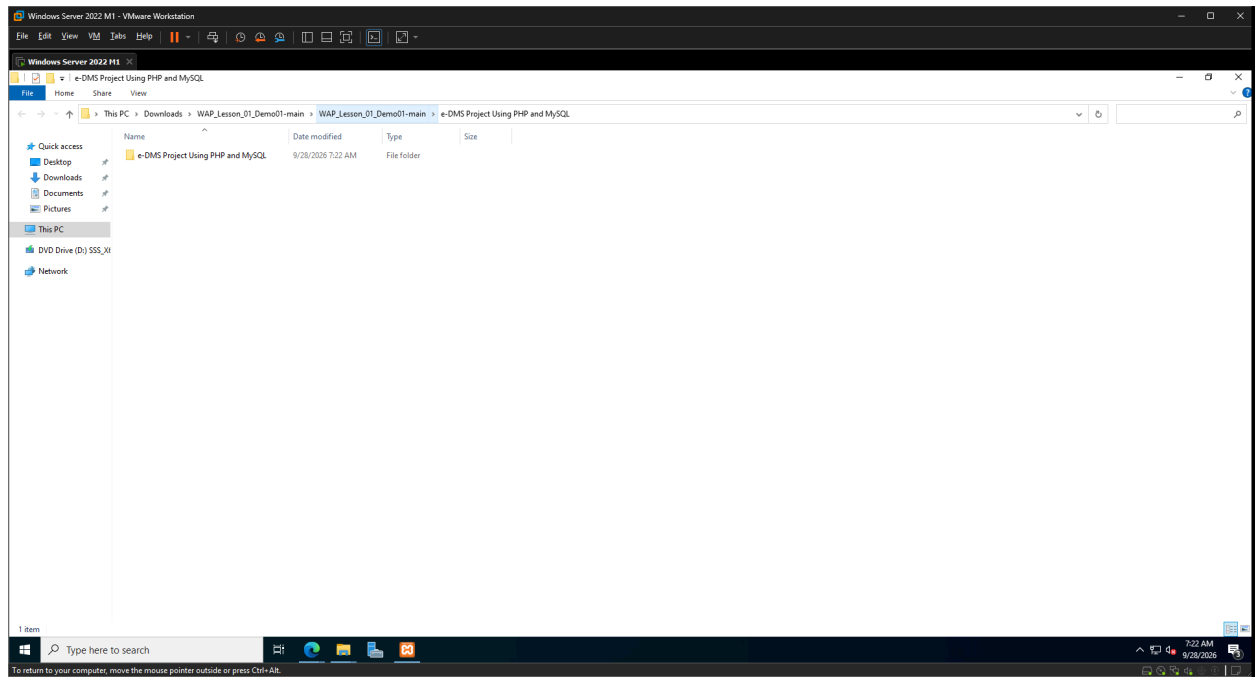
2.7 Right-click e-DMS Project Using PHP and MySQL and click *Extract All...*



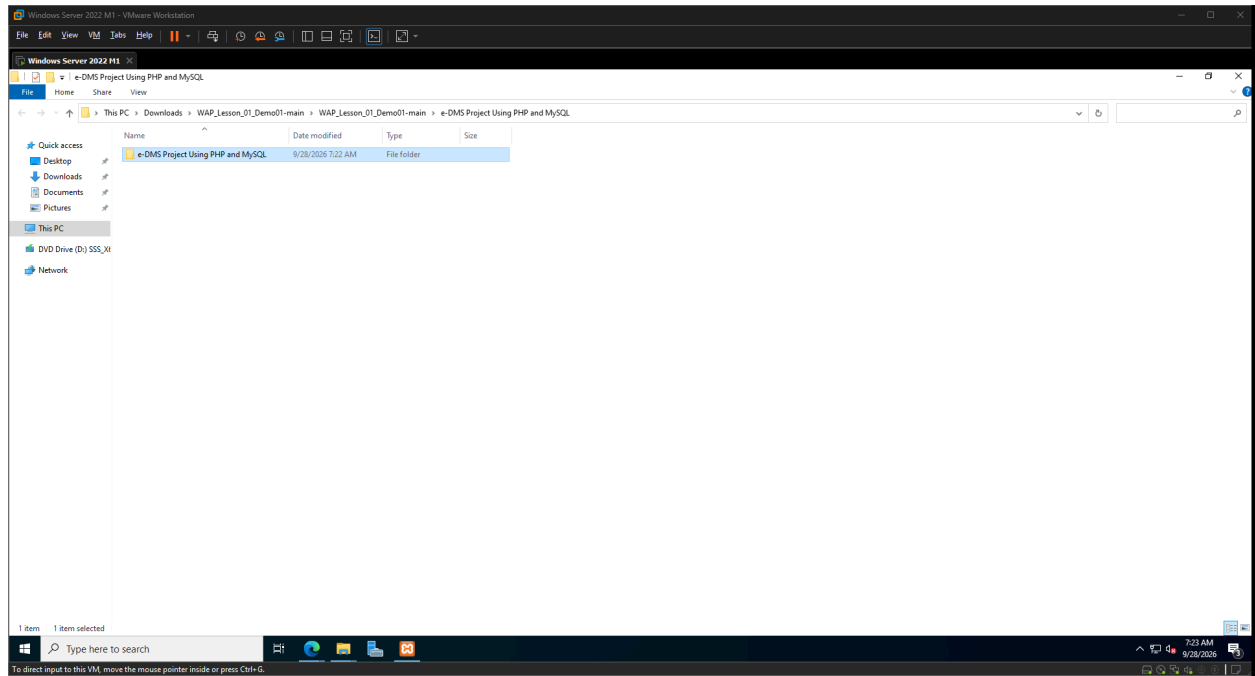
2.8 Click Extract



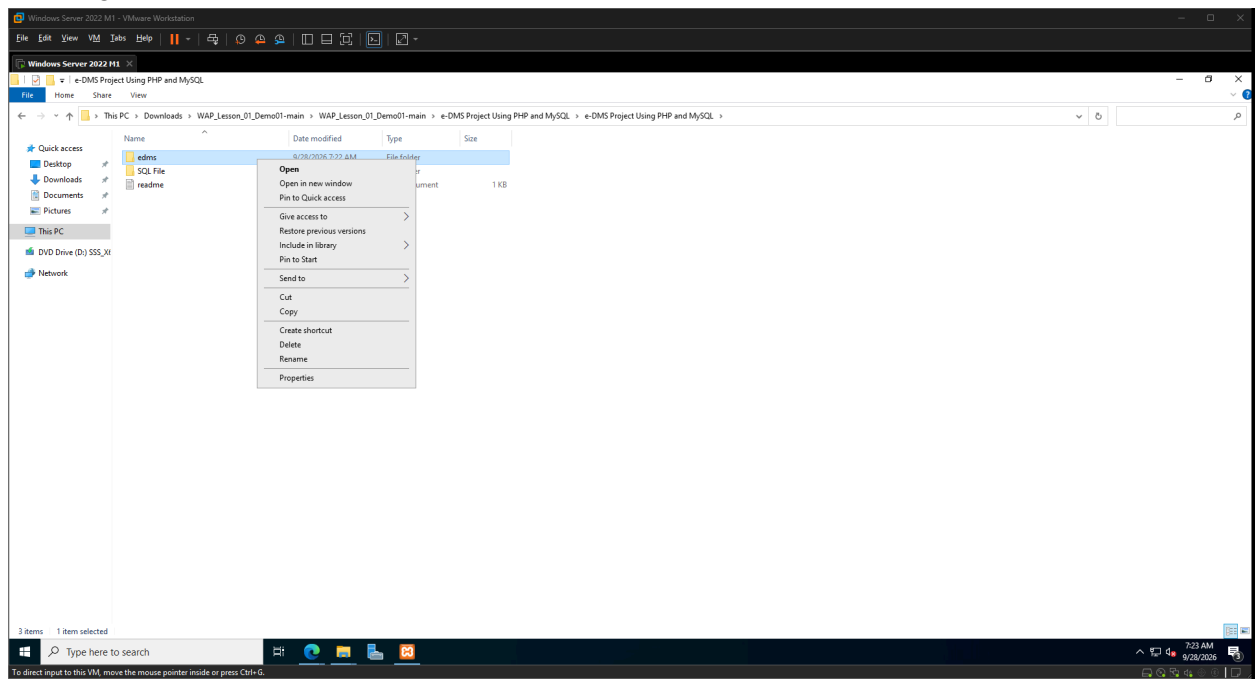
The following page appears:



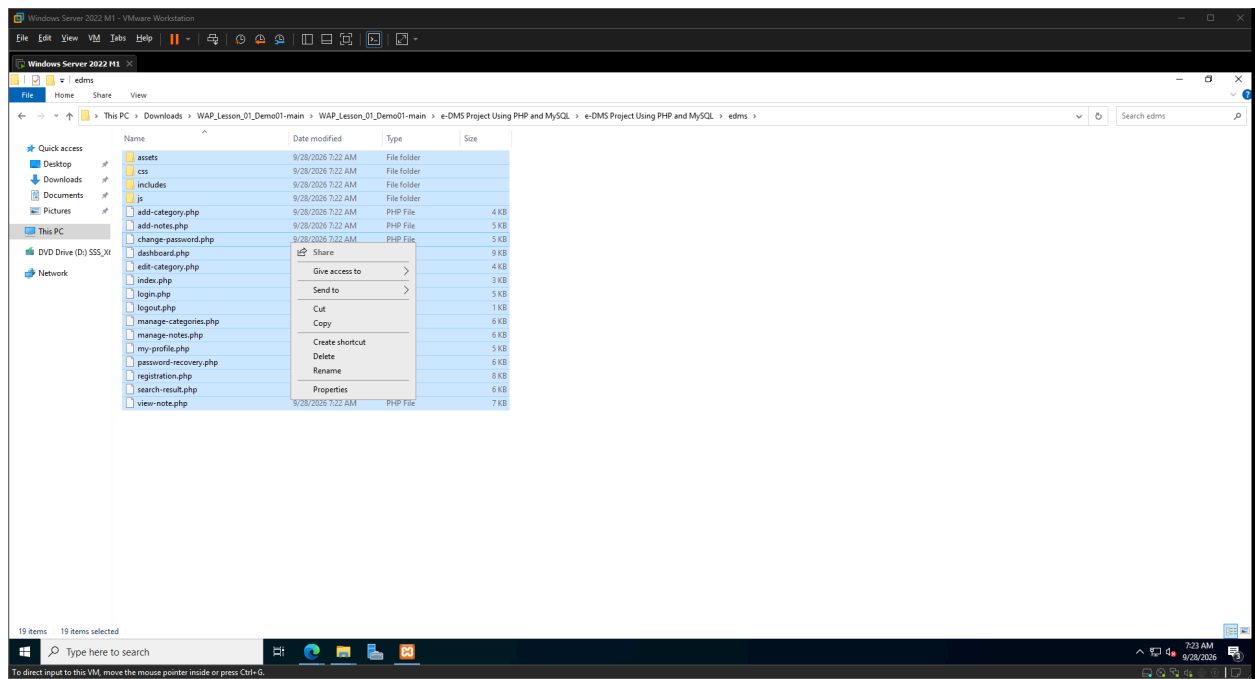
2.9 Double-click e-DMS Project Using PHP and MySQL



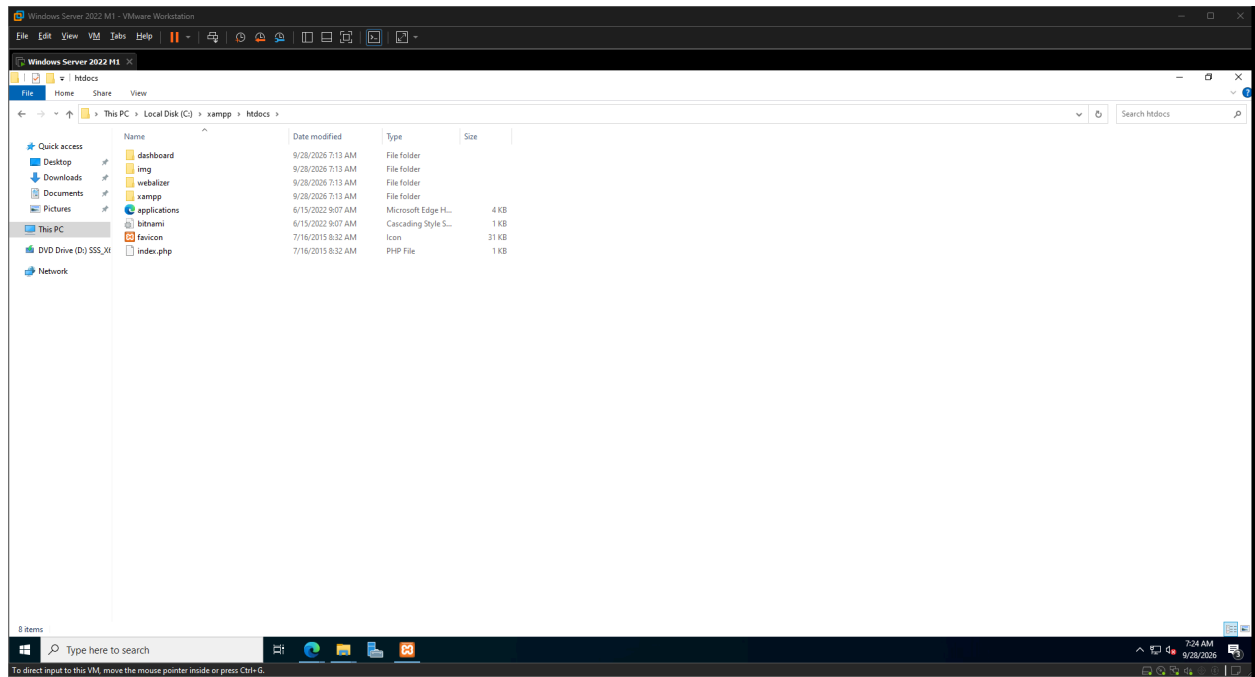
2.10 Right-click the edms folder and click Open



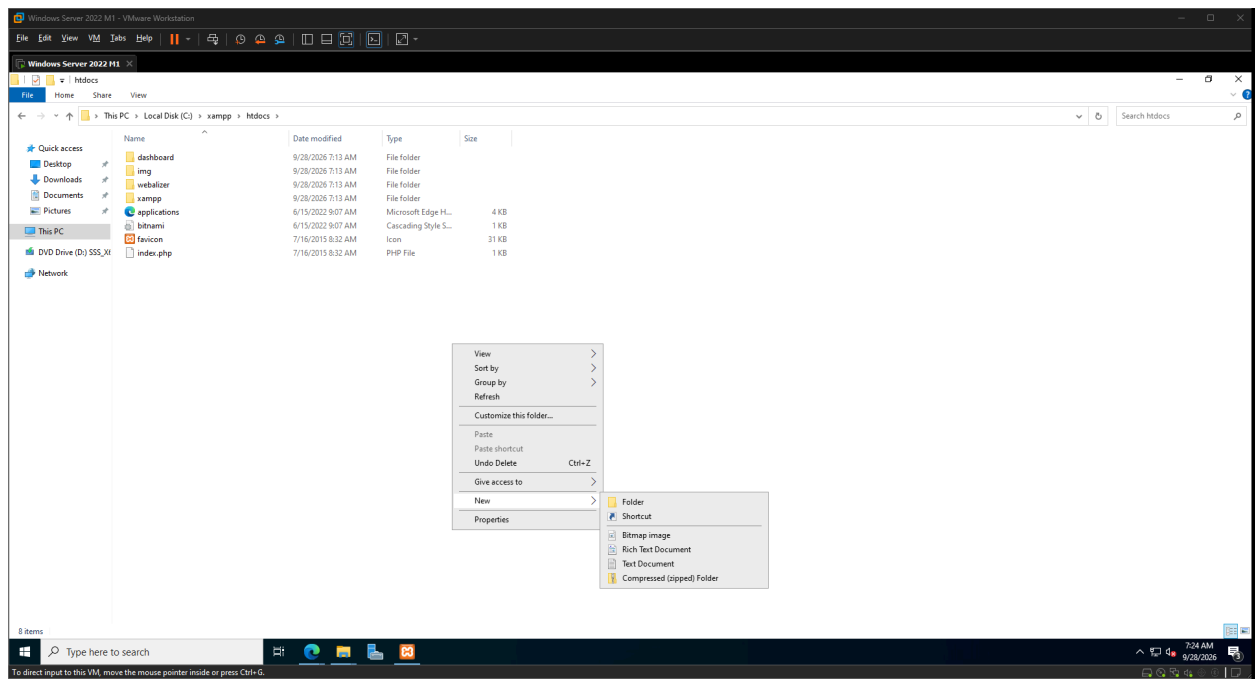
2.11 Select all the files using Ctrl + A, then right-click them and click Copy



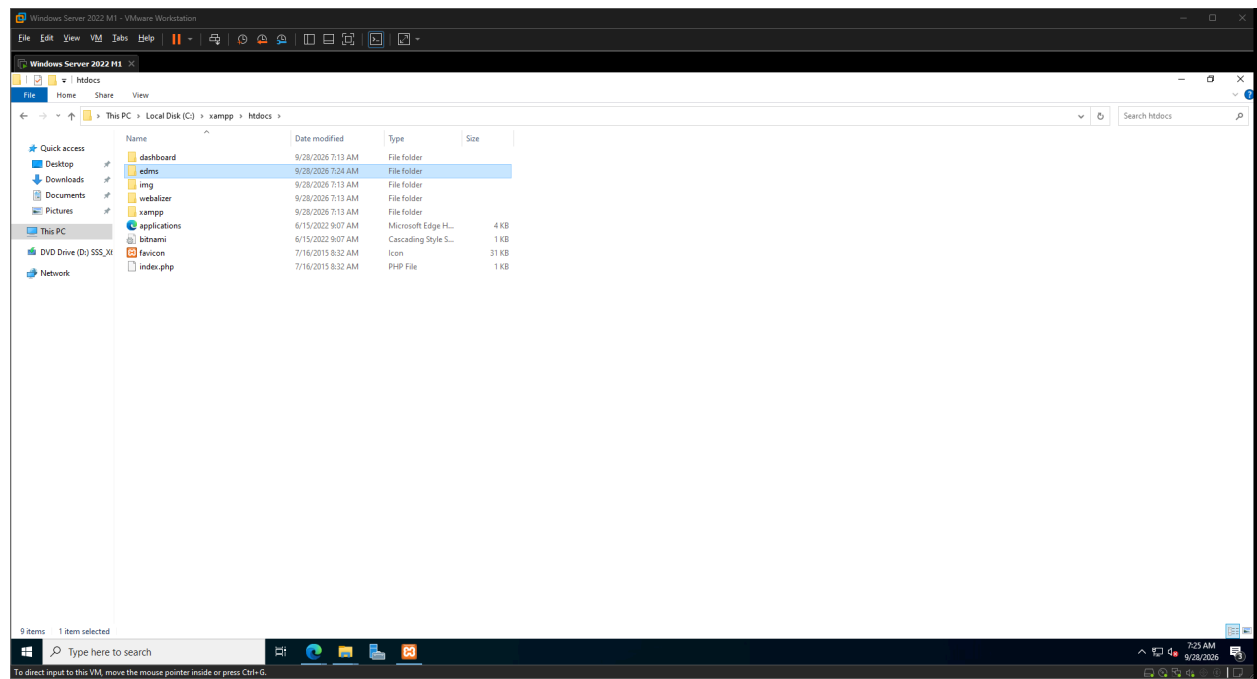
2.12 Now, navigate to This PC > Windows (C:) > xampp > htdocs >



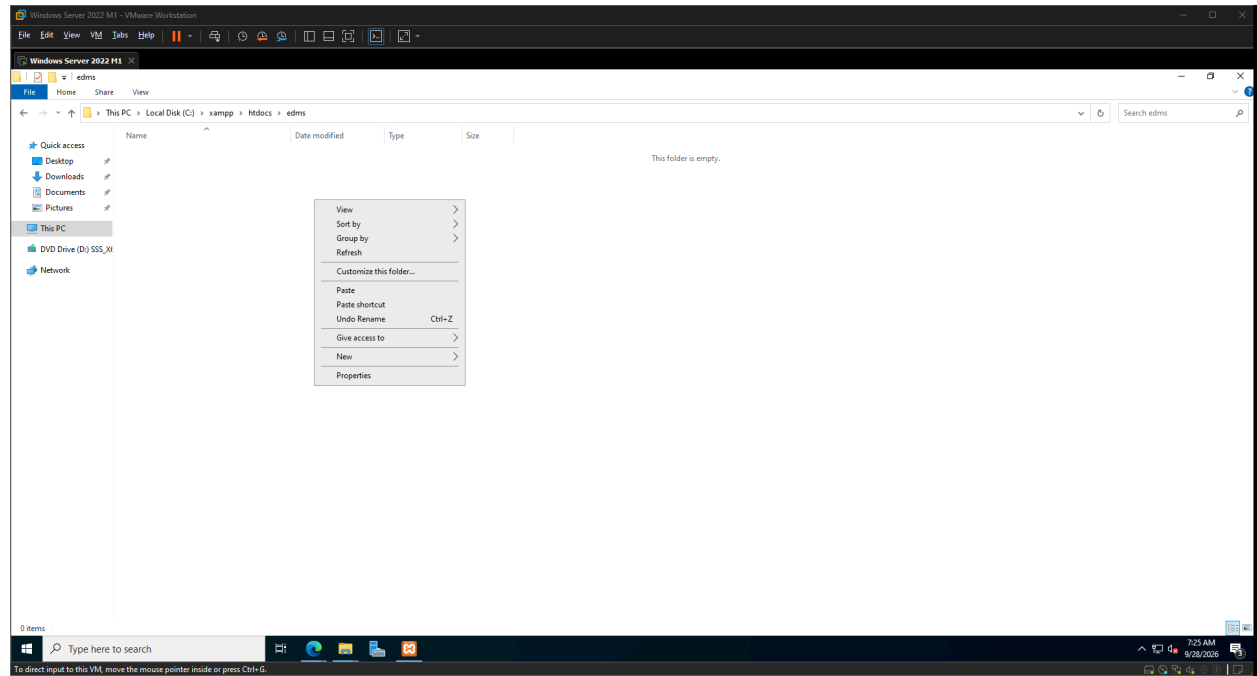
2.13 Right-click on an empty space, select New, and click Folder



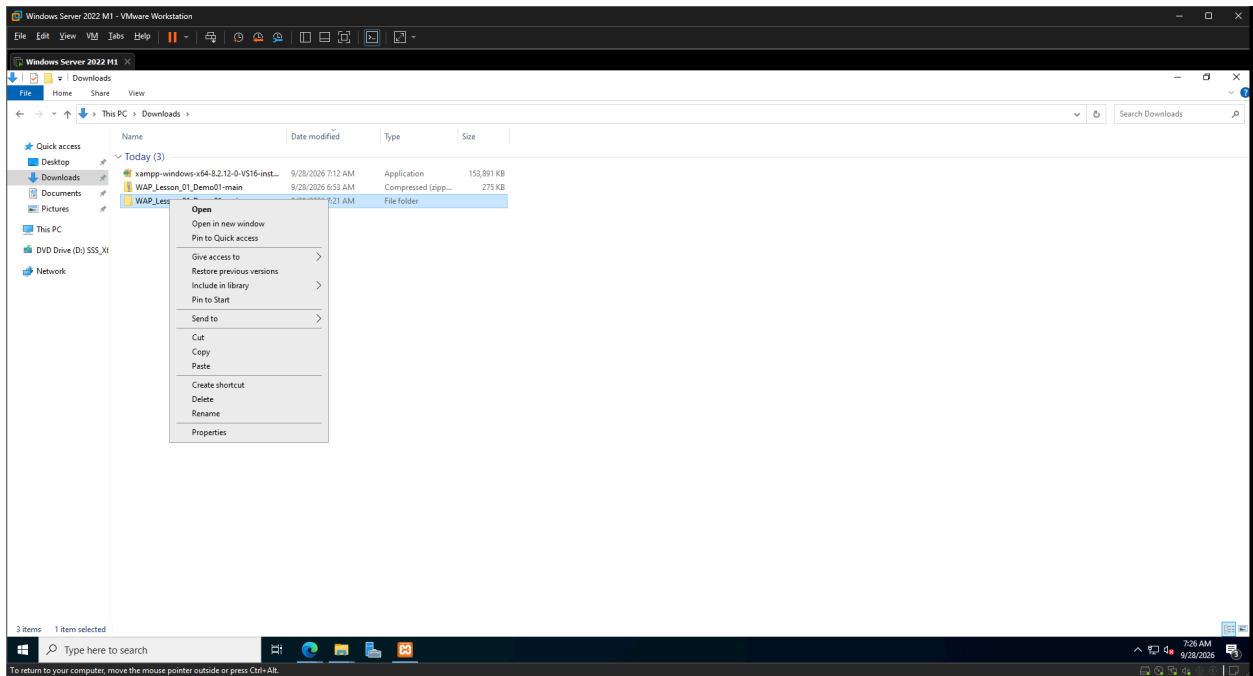
2.14 Name the new folder edms



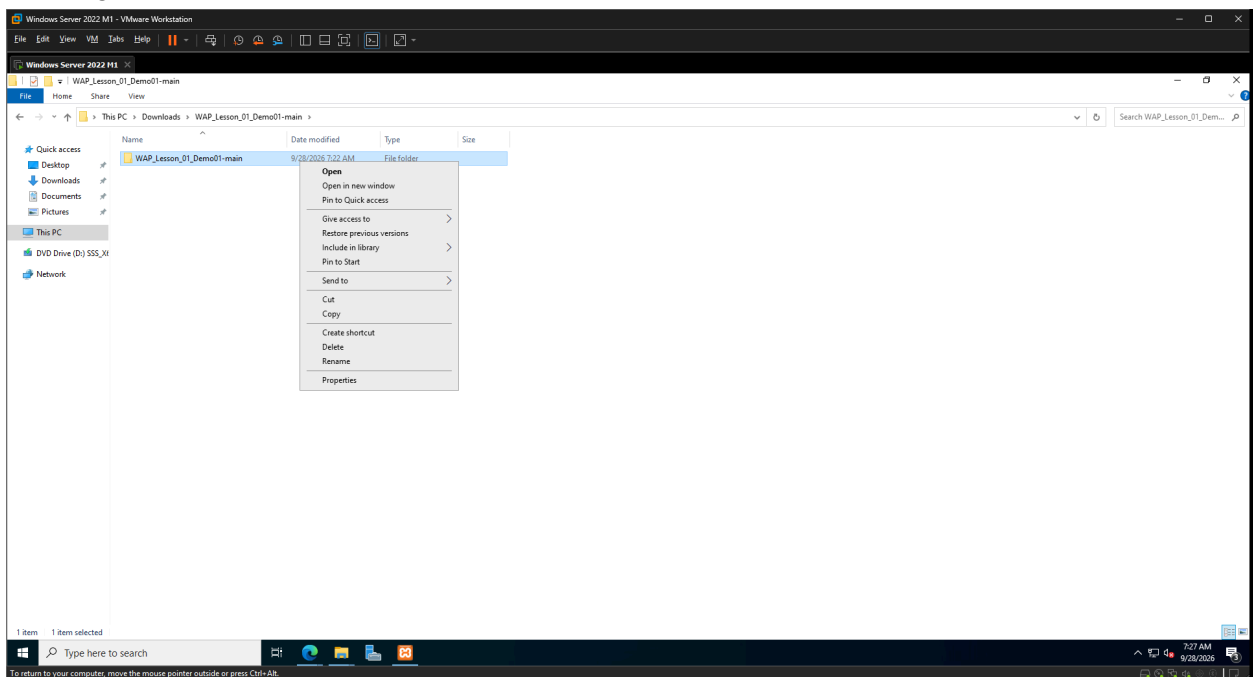
2.15 Open the edms folder, right-click an empty space, and click Paste



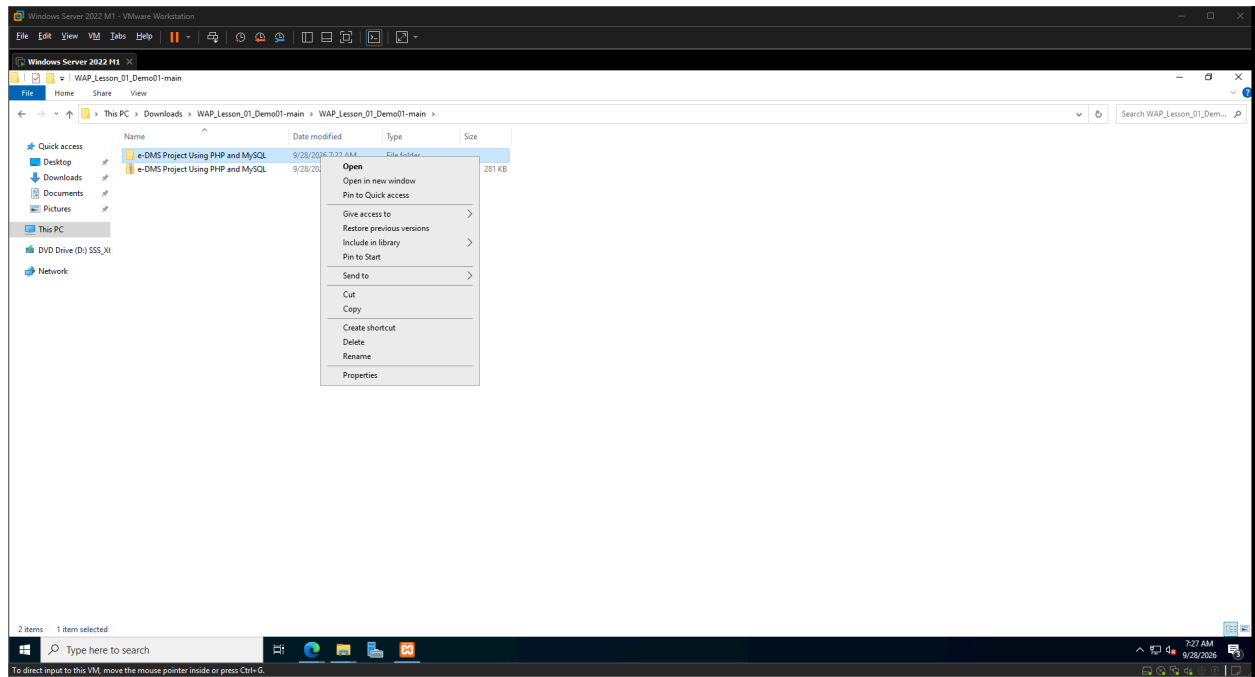
2.16 Navigate to the Downloads folder, right-click WAP_Lesson_01_Demo01-main and click Open



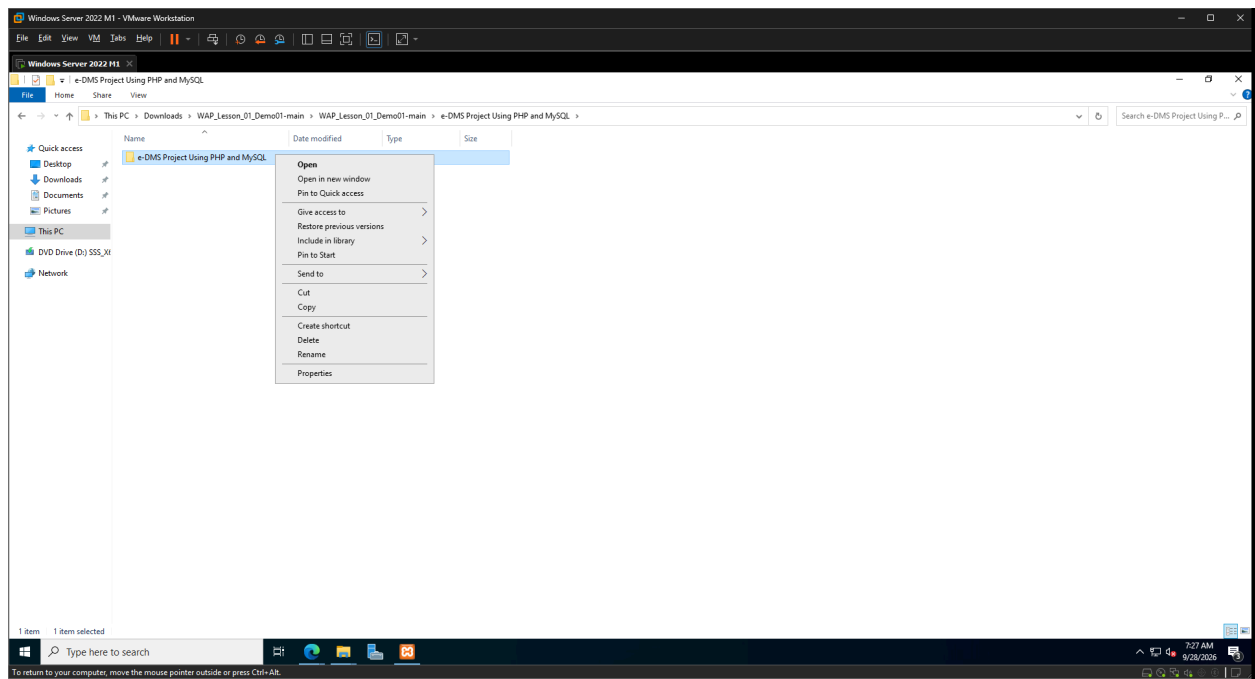
2.17 Right-click WAP_Lesson_01_Demo01-main and click Open



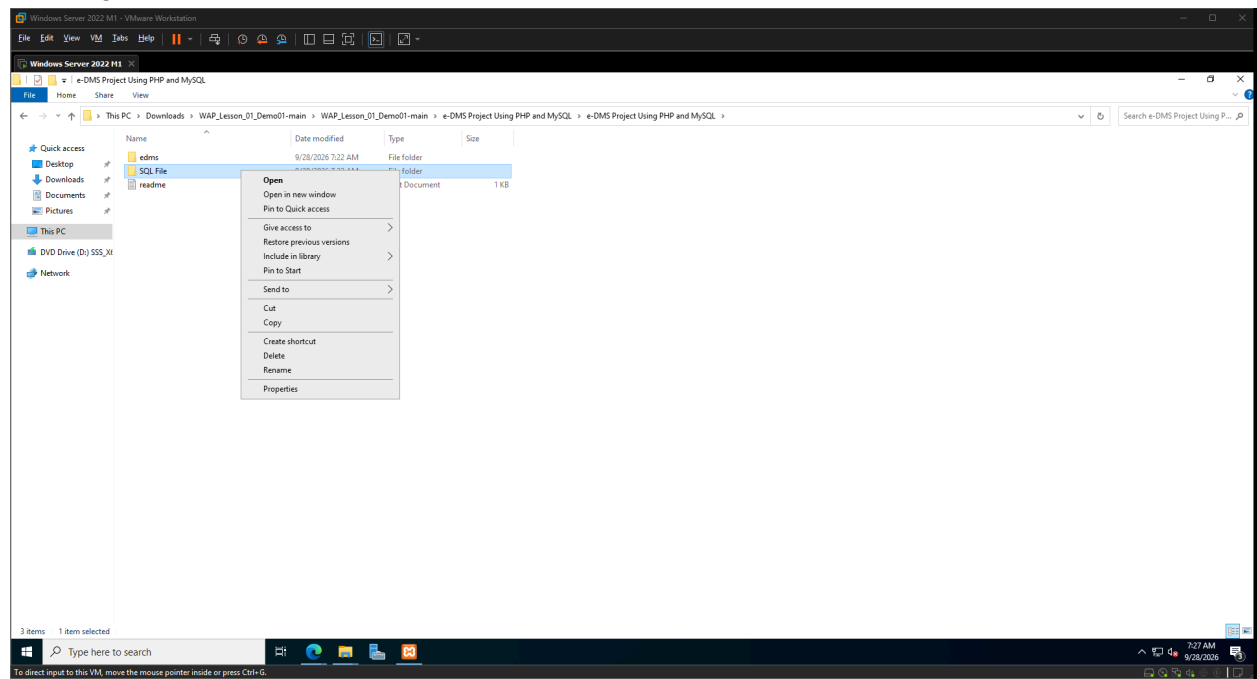
2.18 Right-click e-DMS Project Using PHP and MySQL and click Open



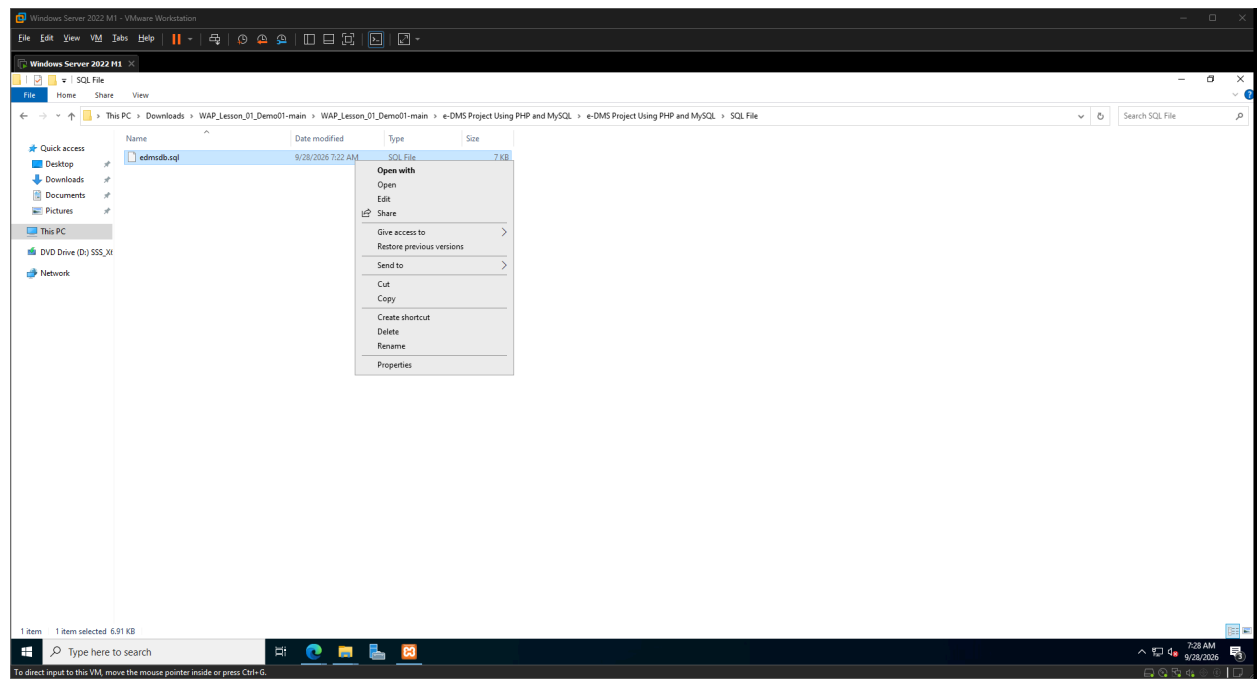
2.19 Right-click e-DMS Project Using PHP and MySQL and click Open again



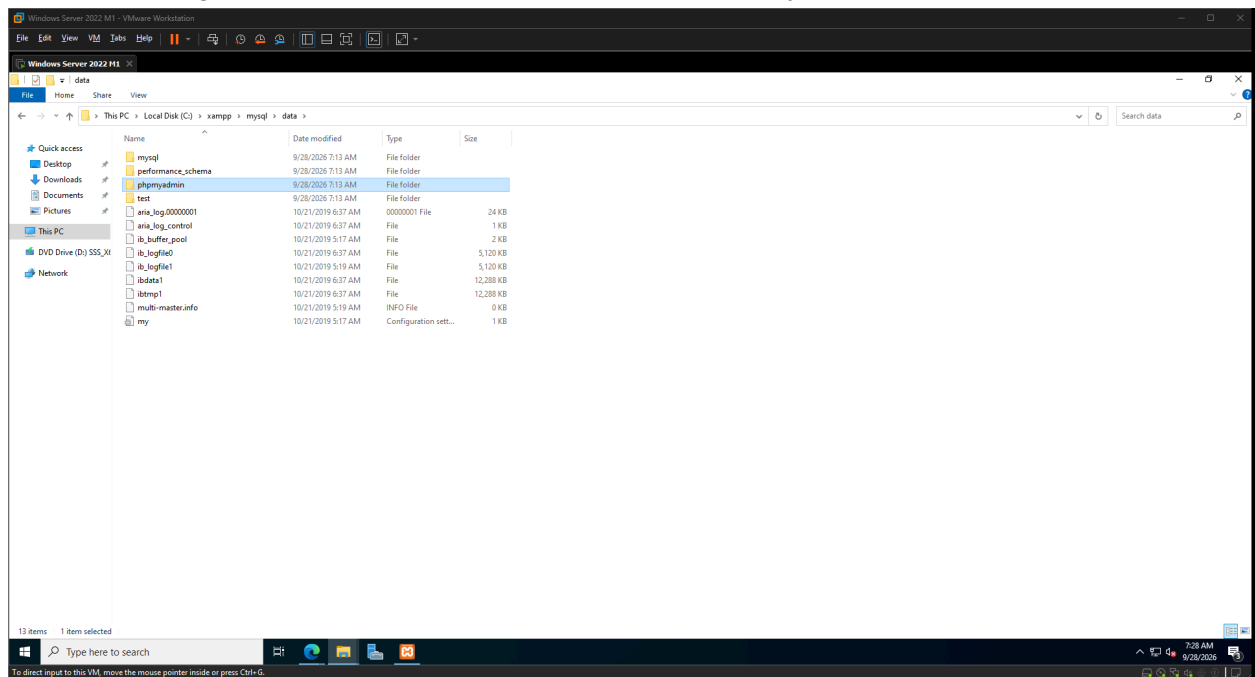
2.20 Right-click SQL File and click Open



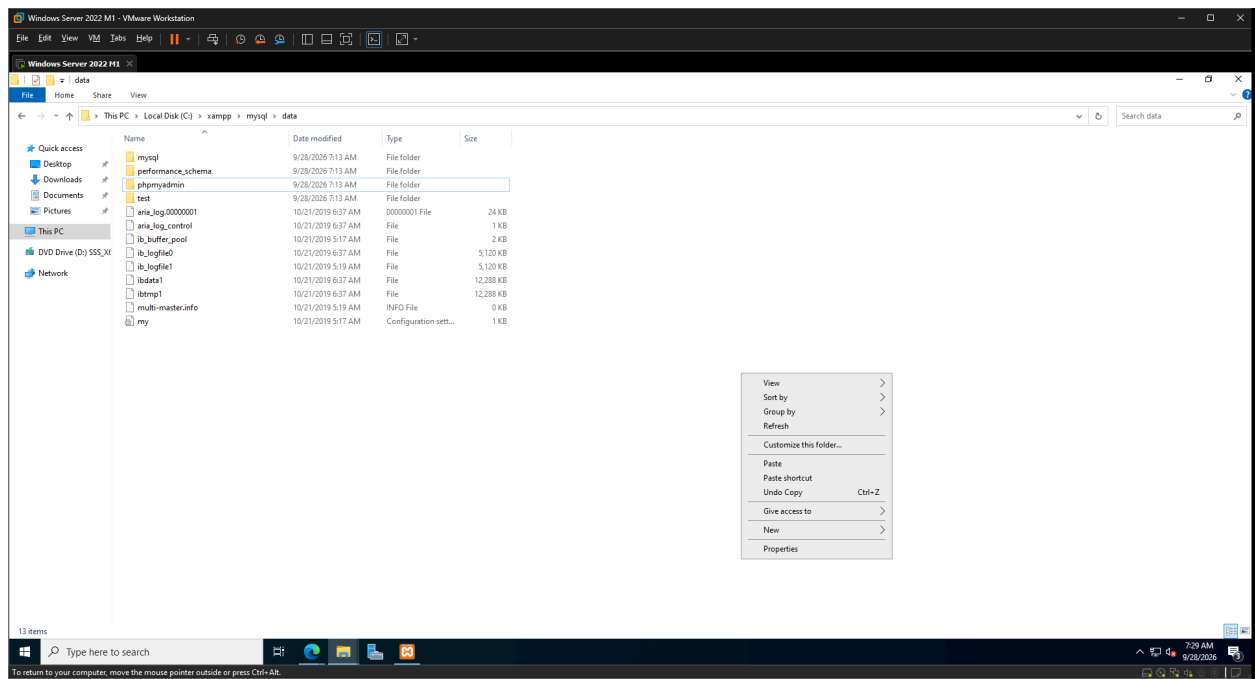
2.21 Right-click edmsdb.sql and select Copy

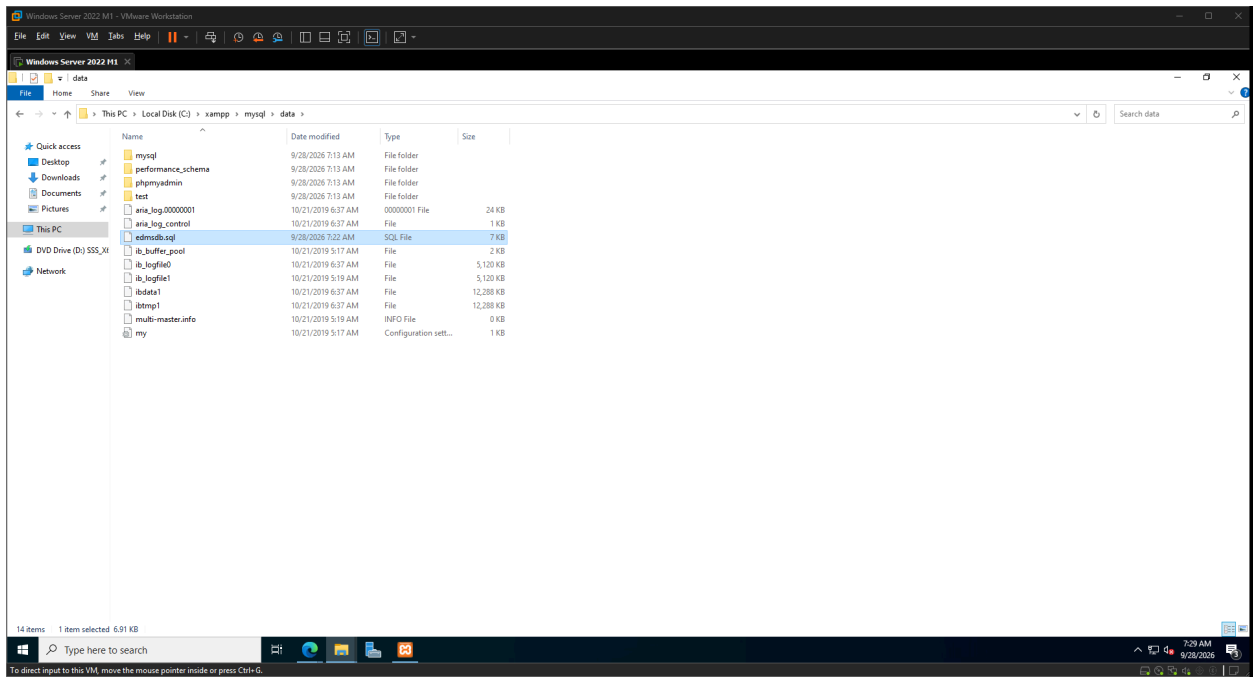


2.22 Now, navigate to This PC > Windows (C:) > xampp > mysql > data >

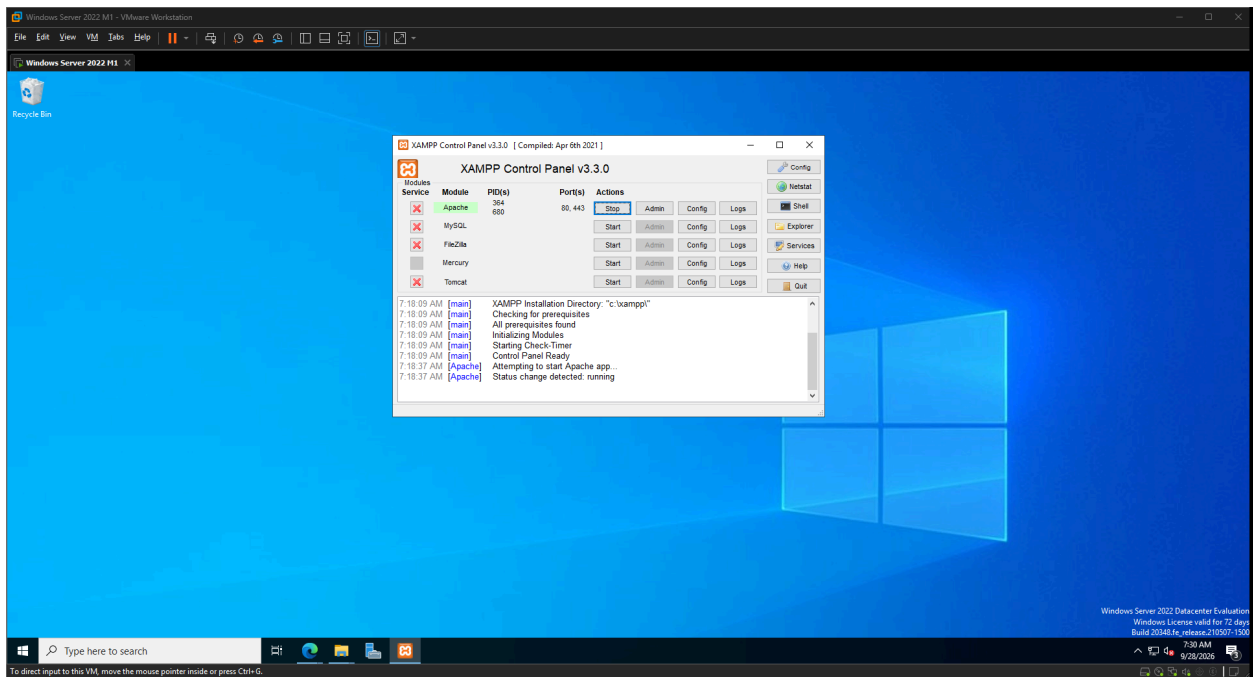


2.23 Paste the file into the folder

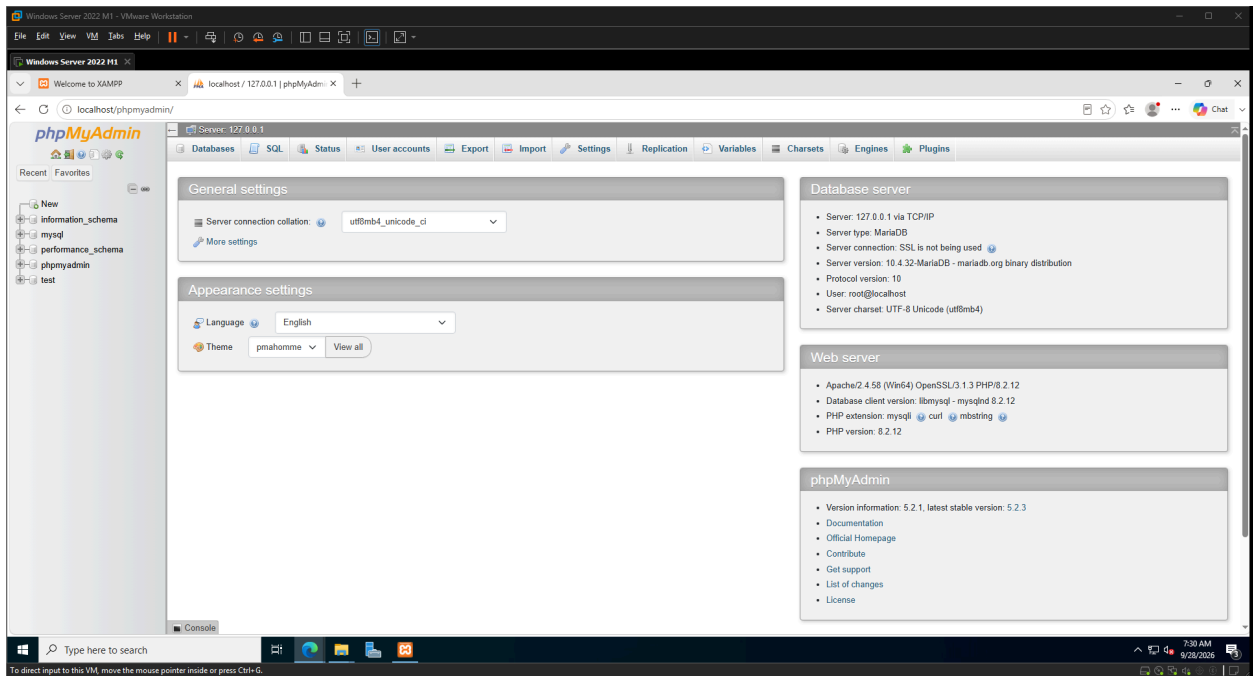




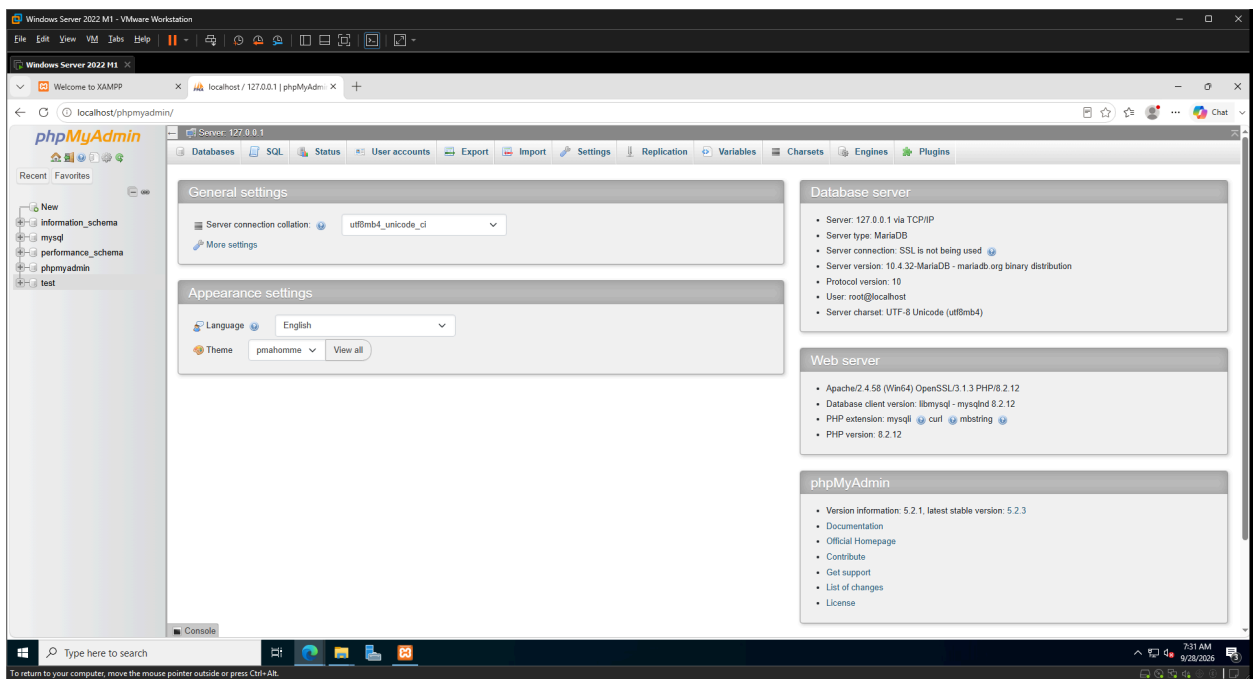
2.24 Navigate back to the XAMPP application, then click Start for MySQL



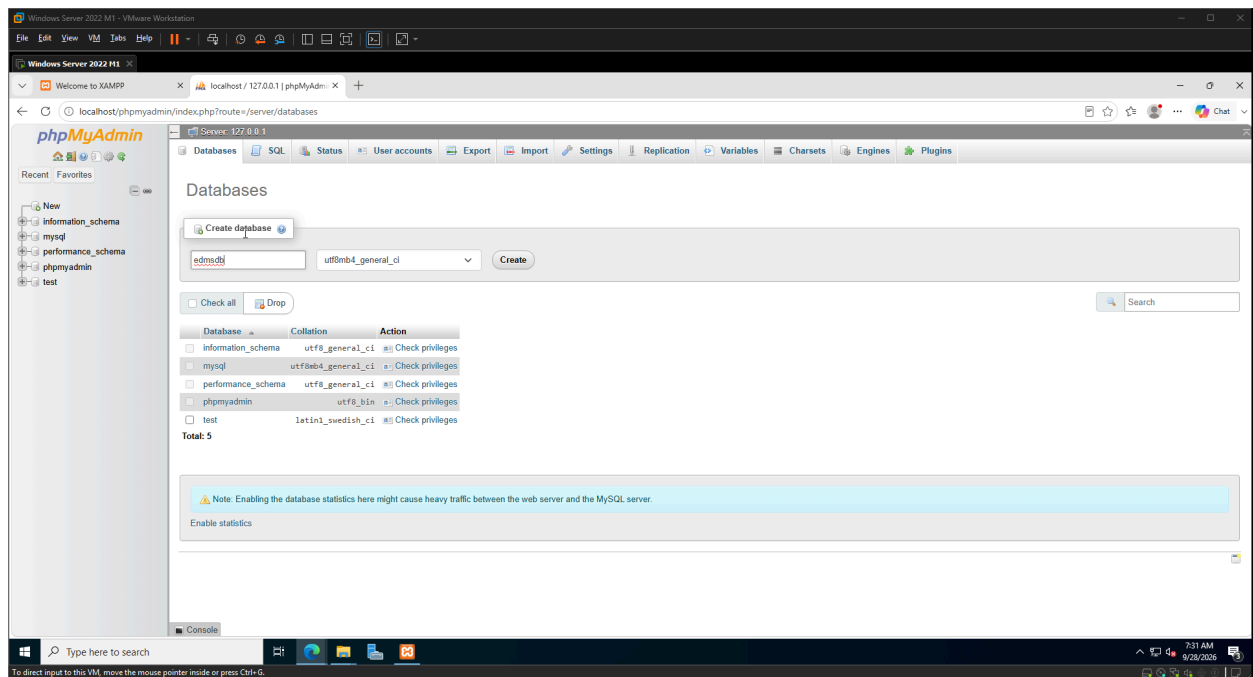
2.25 Navigate back to the Edge browser, type the following URL and press Enter:
<http://localhost/phpmyadmin/>



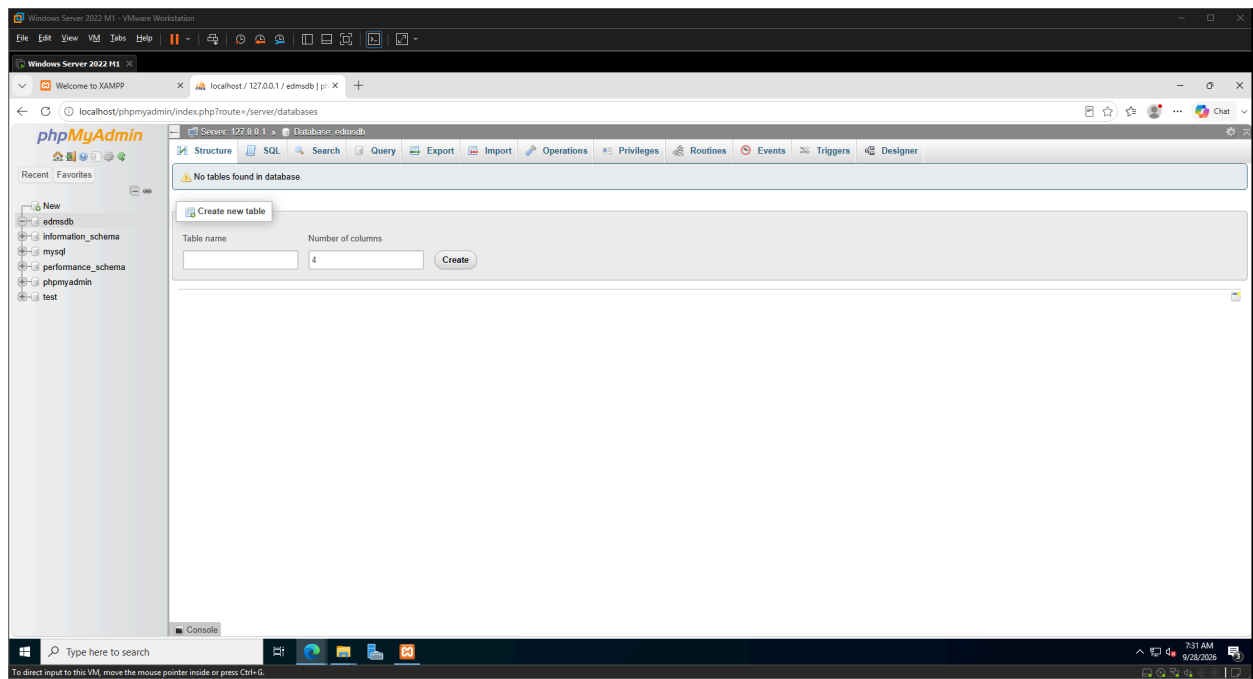
2.26 Click New under the left panel to create a new database



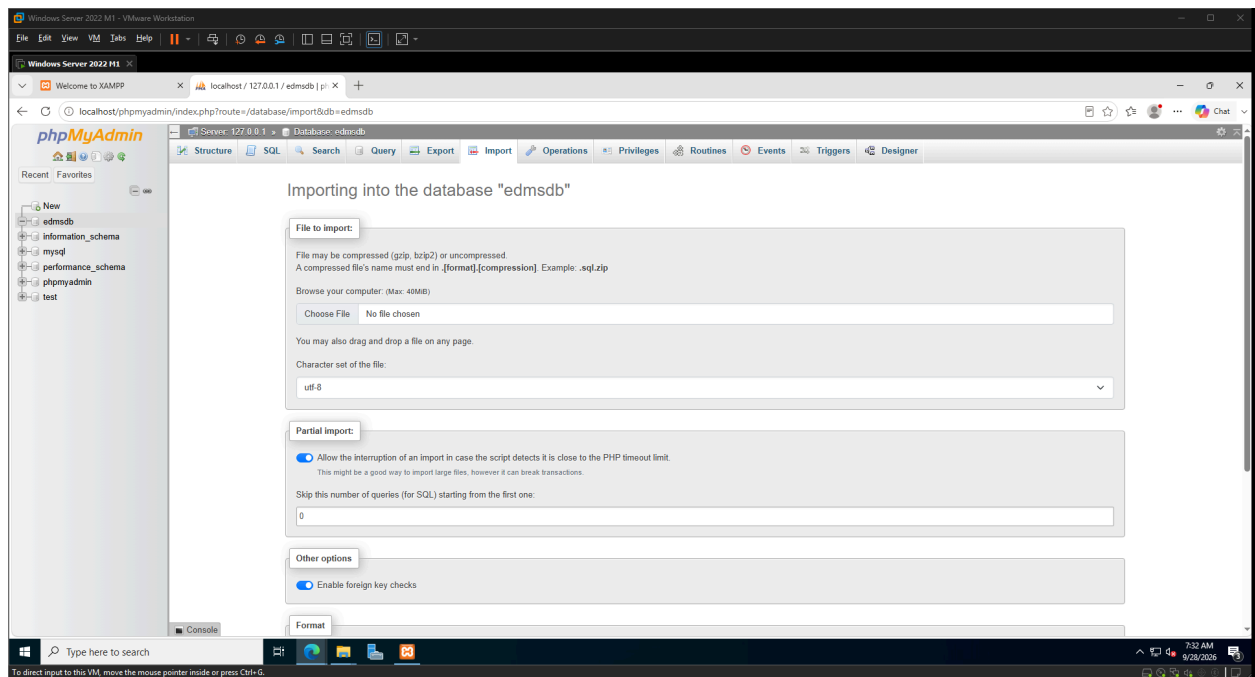
2.27 Enter the database name as edmsdb and click Create



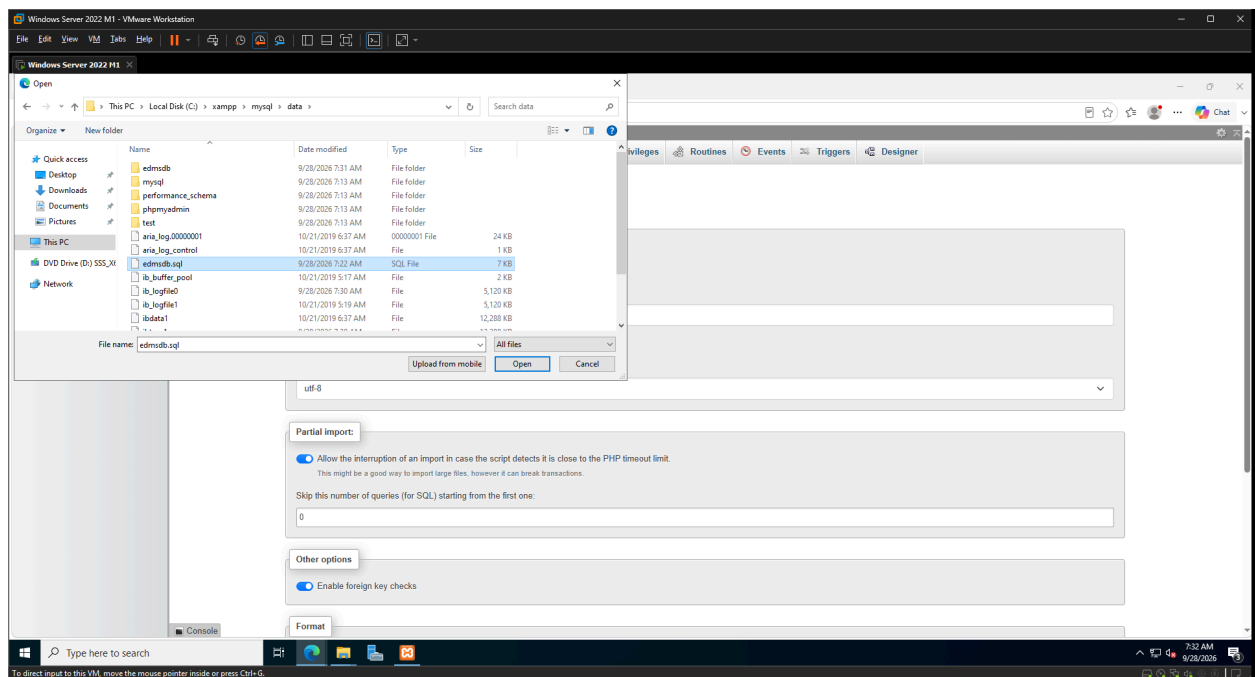
The new database named edmsdb is created, as shown in the following image:



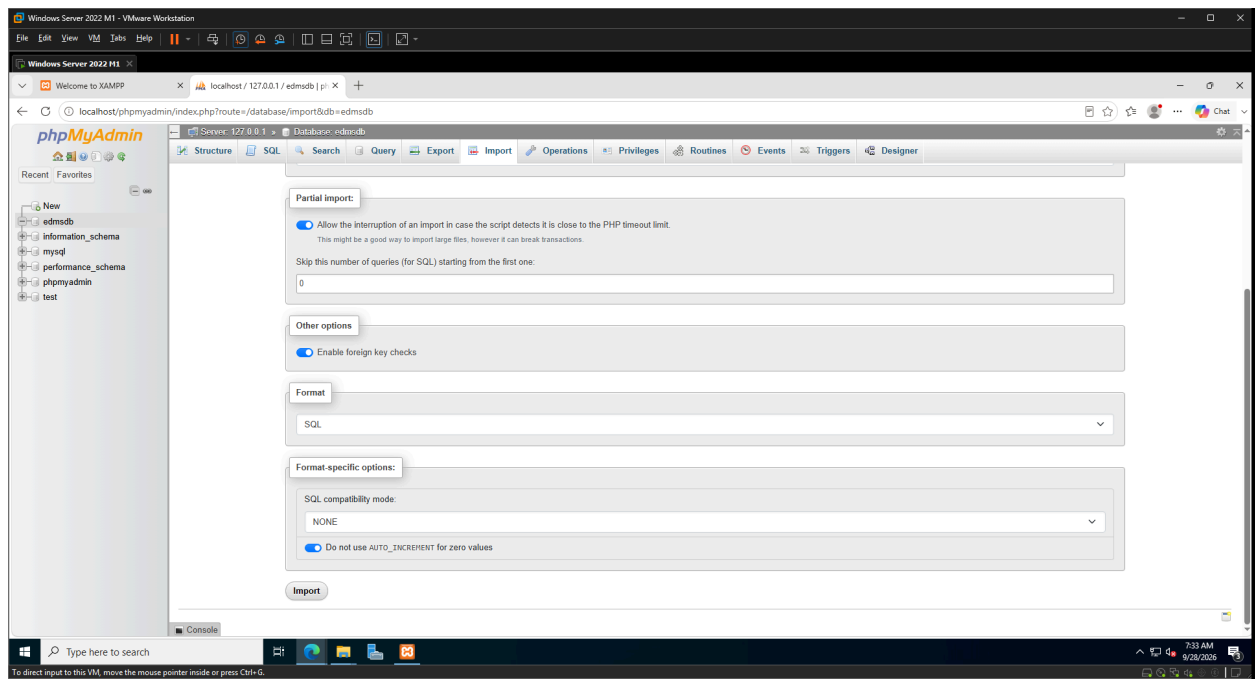
2.28 Click Import, then click Choose File



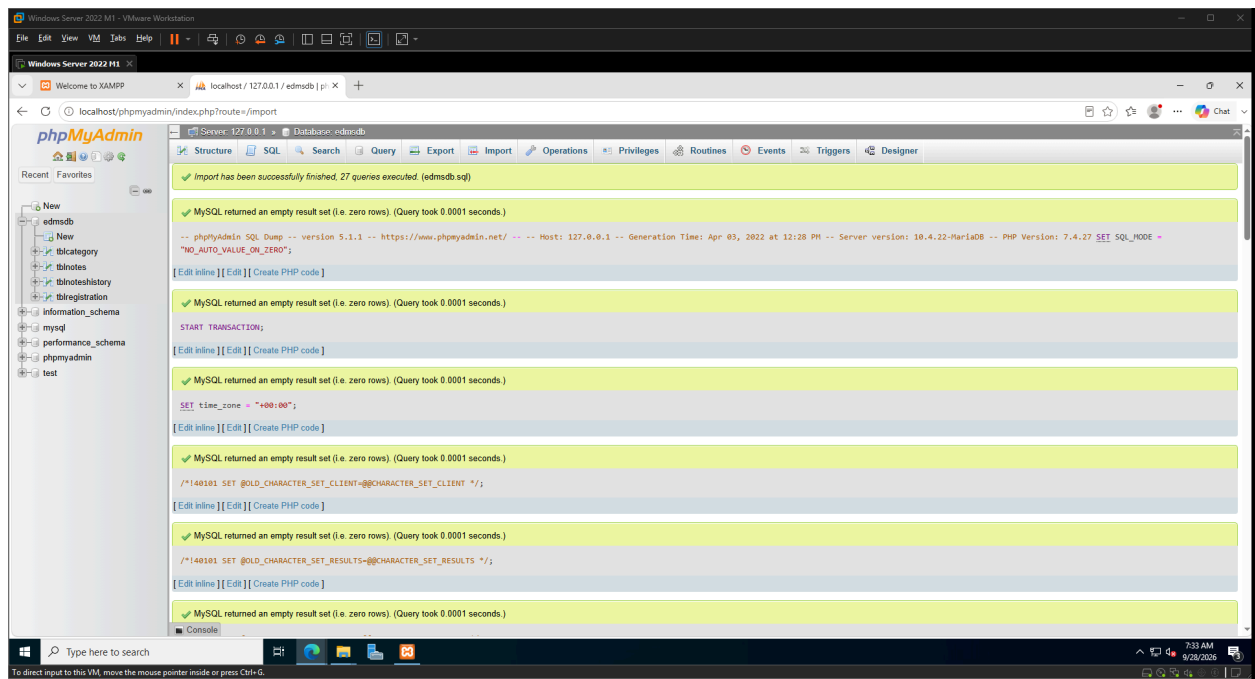
2.29 Navigate to This PC > Windows (C:) > xampp > mysql > data >, select edmsdb.sql, and click Open



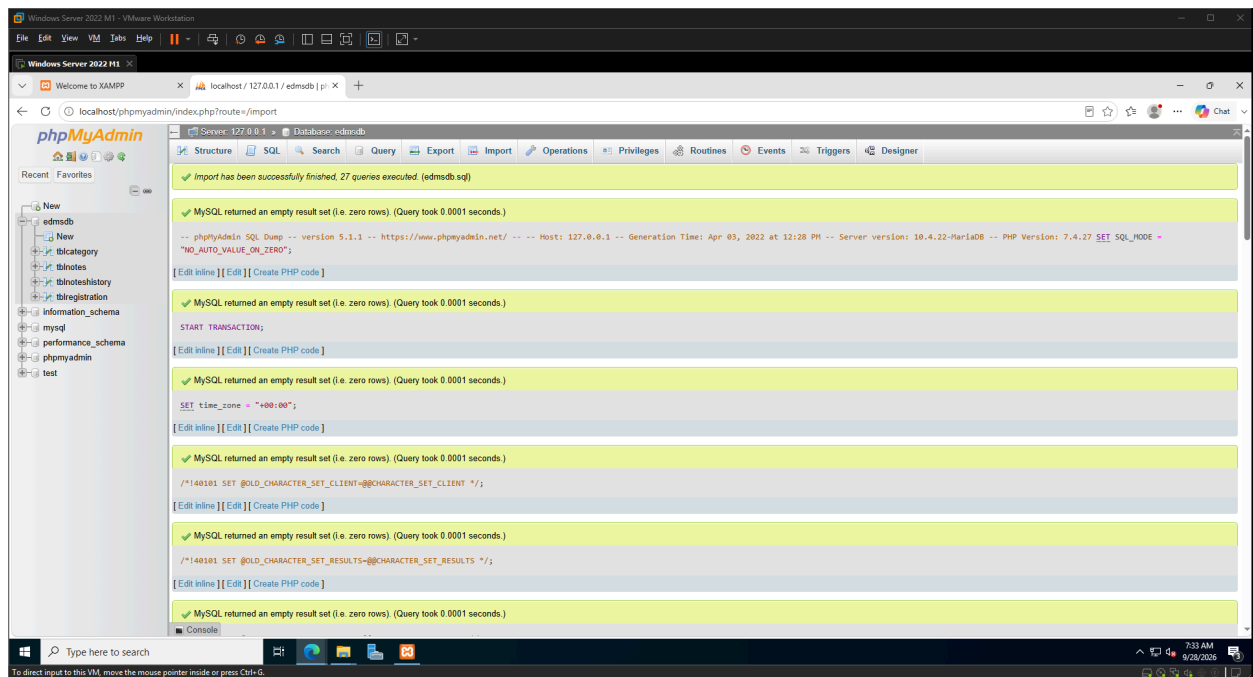
2.30 Scroll-down and click Import



The import is successful, as shown in the following image:

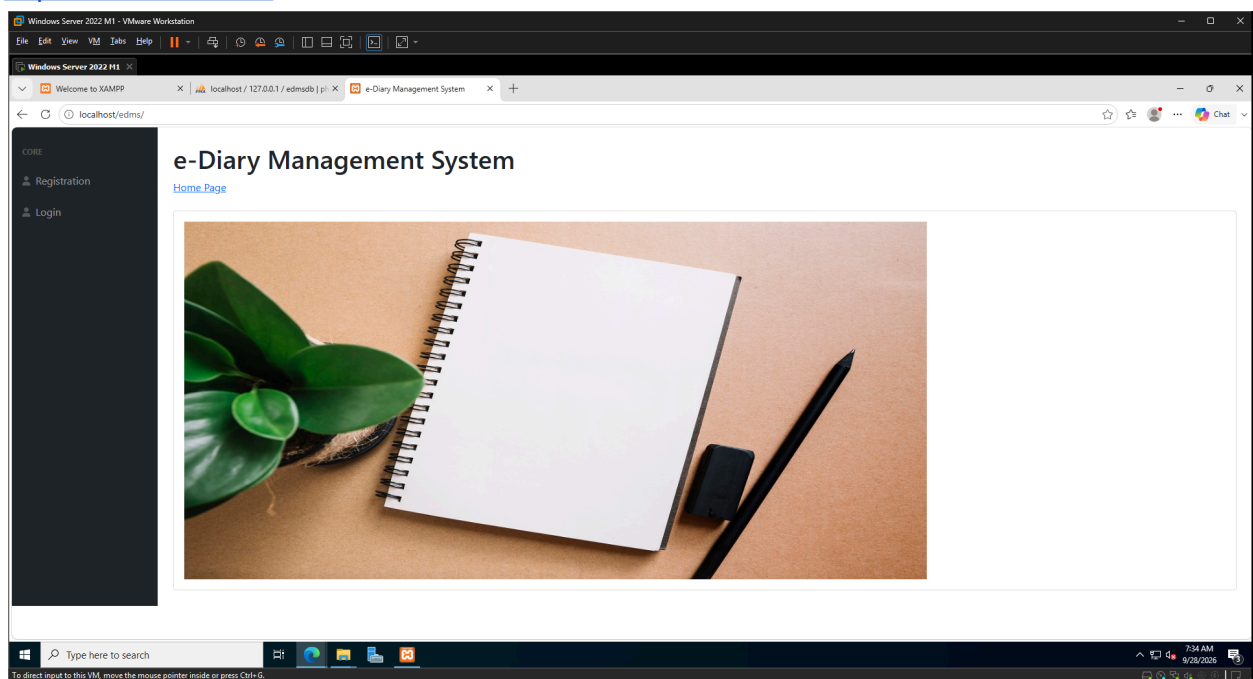


2.31 Click + to open a new tab

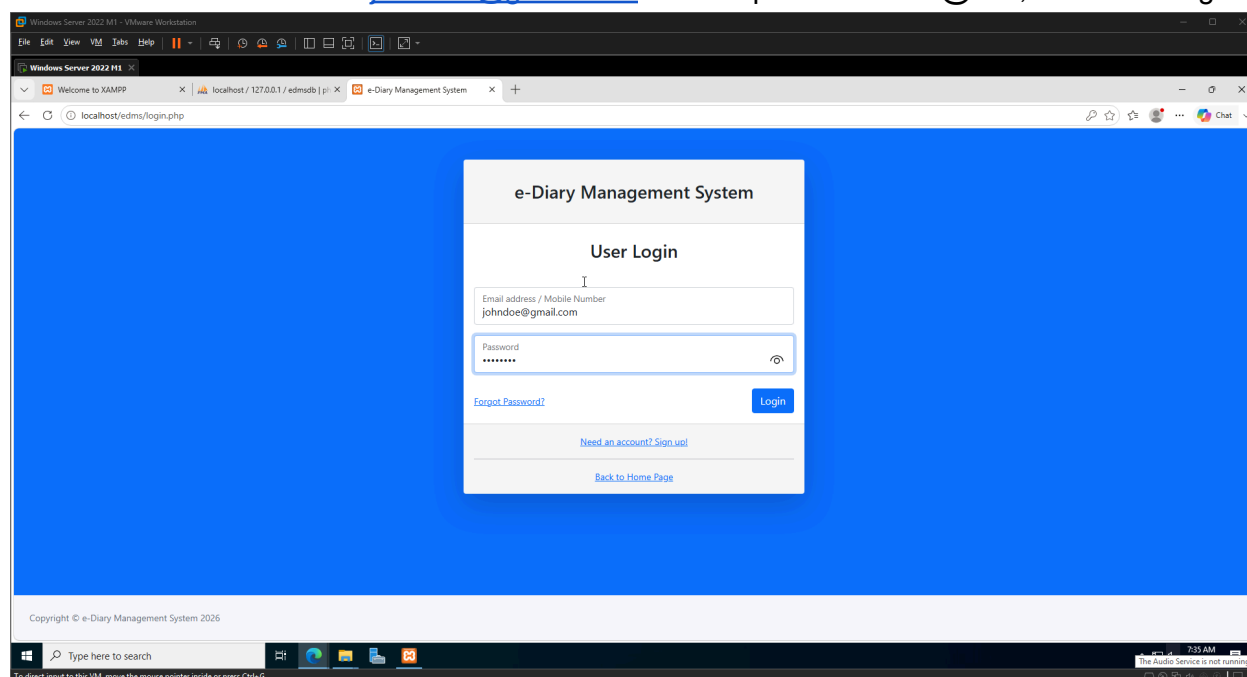


2.32 Type the following URL in the address bar, press Enter, and click Login:

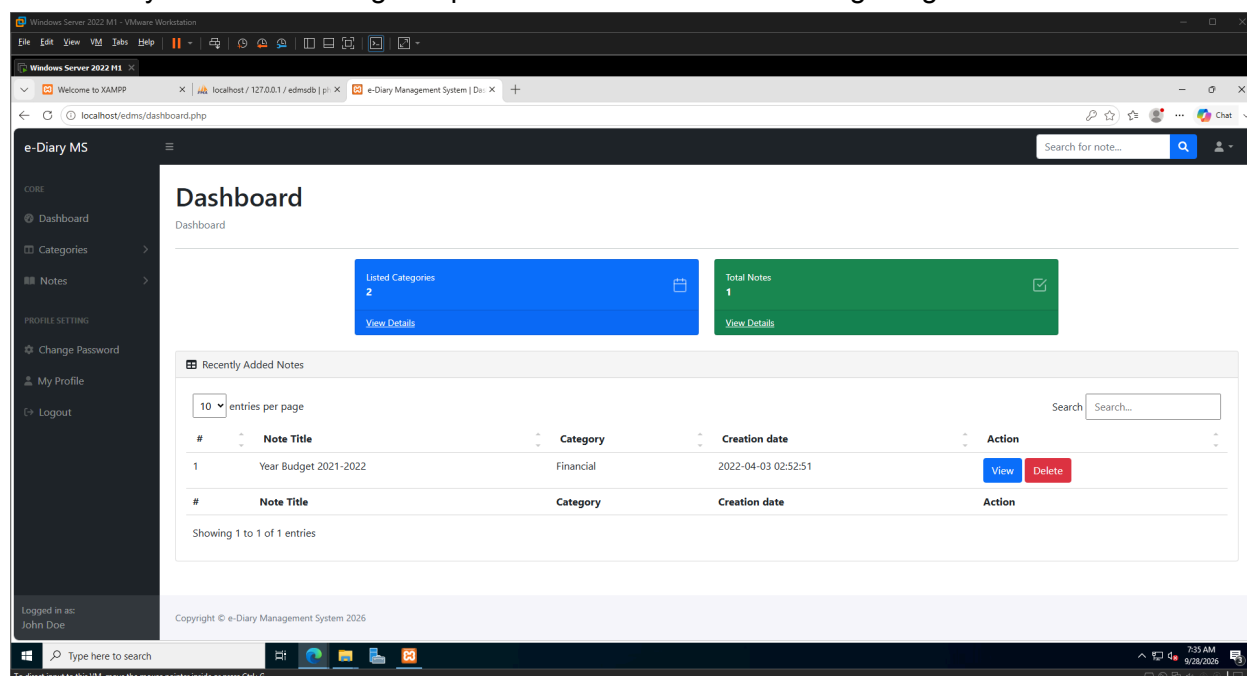
<http://localhost/edms>



2.33 Use the email address johndoe@gmail.com and the password *Test@123*, then click Login



The e-Diary MS Dashboard gets opened as shown in the following image:



By following the above steps, I have successfully hosted a web application on **XAMPP**, enabling efficient testing and debugging with components like **Apache**, **MySQL** and **PHP**. While XAMPP is ideal for local development, transitioning to dedicated servers or cloud platforms is recommended for secure and reliable production hosting.